

Surds and Indices

Index: $a \times a \times a \times a \times a \dots m \text{ times}$
 or $(a \times a \times a \times \dots m \text{ times}) \times (a \times a \times a \times \dots n \text{ times})$
 i.e. $a \times a \times a \times \dots (m+n) \text{ times}$

Important formulae : If $a > 0$, $a \neq 1$, m and n are integers then

$$\begin{array}{llll} \text{(i)} & a^m \times a^n = a^{m+n} & \text{(ii)} & a^m \times a^n \times a^Q = a^{m+n+Q} & \text{(iii)} & (a^m)^n = a^{mn} & \text{(iv)} & \frac{a^m}{a^n} = a^{m-n} \\ \text{(v)} & a^0 = 1 & \text{(vi)} & a^{-m} = \frac{1}{a^m} & \text{(vii)} & a^{m^n} = a^{(m)^n} & \text{(viii)} & (ab)^n = a^n b^n \end{array}$$

Surd : If 'a' is a rational number and n is a positive integer such the n^{th} root of 'a', i.e., $a^{1/n}$ $\sqrt[n]{a}$ is an irrational number, then $a^{1/n}$ is called a surd. In other words, an irrational root of a rational number is called a surd.

Example: $\sqrt{2}$, $\sqrt[3]{4}$, $\sqrt[4]{18}$, $\sqrt[7]{4}$, $\sqrt[3]{9}$ etc. are surds

i.e. we can say that every number expressed in a surd is an irrational number.

Types of surds:

- (i) Pure Surd: $\sqrt{7}$, $3\sqrt{11}$, $\sqrt[4]{125}$ are pure surds.
- (ii) Mixed Surd: $3\sqrt{2}$, $7\sqrt[3]{11}$, $\sqrt{32}$ are mixed surds.
- (iii) Similar surds: $3\sqrt{3}$, $\sqrt{3}$ and $6\sqrt{5}$, $7\sqrt{125} = 35\sqrt{5}$

order of surds: $\sqrt{7}$, $\sqrt[3]{4}$, $\sqrt[4]{8}$, $\sqrt[5]{125}$ are respectively surds of order 2, 3, 4 and 5

Conjugate of surds : Two binomial surds which differ only in sign (+ or -) between the terms connecting them, are known as conjugate surds

Example : Conjugate of $5 + \sqrt{7}$ is $5 - \sqrt{7}$

Condition for two Surds to be equal : If a, b, c, d are all rational numbers and b and d are not perfect square then

$$a + \sqrt{b} = c + \sqrt{d}, \quad \text{i.e. } a = c \text{ and } b = d$$

Square root of surd of $a + \sqrt{b}$ form

$$\sqrt{a + \sqrt{b}} = \sqrt{\frac{a + \sqrt{a^2 - b}}{2}} + \sqrt{\frac{a - \sqrt{a^2 - b}}{2}}, \quad \sqrt{a - \sqrt{b}} = \sqrt{\frac{a + \sqrt{a^2 - b}}{2}} - \sqrt{\frac{a - \sqrt{a^2 - b}}{2}}$$

Important formulae:

$$\begin{array}{lll} \text{(i)} & a^{-p} = \frac{1}{a^p} & \text{(ii)} \text{ If } a^y = n \text{ then } a = (n)^{1/y} & \text{(iii)} \text{ If } a^x = b^y \text{ then } a = (b)^{y/x} \\ \text{(iv)} & x^n = a, \quad x = \sqrt[n]{a} & \text{(v)} & \sqrt[n]{a} = a^{1/n} & \text{(vi)} & (\sqrt[n]{a})^m = a^{\frac{m}{n}} \\ \text{(vii)} & \sqrt[n]{a} \cdot \sqrt[n]{b} = \sqrt[n]{ab} \end{array}$$

Types of Questions

1. The greatest among $\sqrt{7} - \sqrt{5}, \sqrt{5} - \sqrt{3},$

$$\sqrt{9} - \sqrt{7}, \sqrt{11} - \sqrt{9}$$

Sol. On rationalising

$$\frac{(\sqrt{7} - \sqrt{5}) \times (\sqrt{7} + \sqrt{5})}{\sqrt{7} + \sqrt{5}}, \frac{(\sqrt{5} - \sqrt{3}) \times (\sqrt{5} + \sqrt{3})}{\sqrt{5} + \sqrt{3}},$$

$$\frac{(\sqrt{9} - \sqrt{7}) \times (\sqrt{9} + \sqrt{7})}{\sqrt{9} + \sqrt{7}}, \frac{(\sqrt{11} - \sqrt{9}) \times (\sqrt{11} + \sqrt{9})}{(\sqrt{11} + \sqrt{9})}$$

$$= \frac{2}{\sqrt{7} + \sqrt{5}}, \frac{2}{\sqrt{5} + \sqrt{3}}, \frac{2}{\sqrt{9} + \sqrt{7}}, \frac{2}{\sqrt{11} + \sqrt{9}}$$

$$\text{smallest one} = \frac{2}{\sqrt{11} + \sqrt{9}} = \sqrt{11} - \sqrt{9}$$

$$\text{Greatest one} = \frac{2}{\sqrt{5} + \sqrt{3}} = \sqrt{5} - \sqrt{3}$$

2. Greatest among the following numbers

$$\sqrt[3]{9}, \sqrt{3}, \sqrt[4]{16}, \sqrt[6]{80}$$

Sol. LCM 3, 2, 4, and 6 = 12

$$9^{12/3}, 3^{12/2}, 16^{12/4}, \text{ and } 80^{12/6}$$

$$9^4, 3^6, 16^3, 80^2$$

$$6561, 729, 4096, 6400$$

$$\text{i.e. largest one} = \sqrt[3]{9}.$$

3. By how much does $\sqrt{12} + \sqrt{18}$ exceed $\sqrt{3} + \sqrt{2}$?

Sol. Required value will be the difference between

$$\sqrt{12} + \sqrt{18} \text{ and } (\sqrt{3} + \sqrt{2})$$

$$= (\sqrt{12} + \sqrt{18}) - (\sqrt{3} + \sqrt{2})$$

$$= (2\sqrt{3} + 3\sqrt{2}) - (\sqrt{3} + \sqrt{2})$$

$$= \sqrt{3} + 2\sqrt{2}$$

4. Is $2^x = 3^y = 6^{-z}$ then $\left(\frac{1}{x} + \frac{1}{y} + \frac{1}{z}\right)$ is equal to

Sol. Let $2^x = 3^y = 6^{-z} = k$

$$\text{i.e. } 2 = k^{1/x}, \quad 3 = k^{1/y}, \quad 6 = k^{-1/z},$$

$$2 \times 3 = 6$$

$$k^{1/x} \times k^{1/y} = k^{-1/z}, \quad k^{1/x + 1/y} = k^{-1/z}$$

$$\frac{1}{x} + \frac{1}{y} = -\frac{1}{z}, \quad \frac{1}{x} + \frac{1}{y} + \frac{1}{z} = 0$$

5. Find the value of $3 + \frac{1}{\sqrt{3}} + \frac{1}{\sqrt{3} + 3} + \frac{1}{\sqrt{3} - 3}$

$$\text{Sol. } 3 + \frac{1 \times \sqrt{3}}{\sqrt{3} \times \sqrt{3}} + \frac{1}{(\sqrt{3} + 3)} \times \frac{3 - \sqrt{3}}{3 - \sqrt{3}} + \frac{1}{(\sqrt{3} - 3)} \times \frac{3 + \sqrt{3}}{3 + \sqrt{3}}$$

$$= 3 + \frac{\sqrt{3}}{3} + \frac{3 - \sqrt{3}}{6} - \frac{3 + \sqrt{3}}{6} = \frac{18}{6} = 3$$

6. The value of $\sqrt{5 + 2\sqrt{6}} - \frac{1}{\sqrt{5 + 2\sqrt{6}}}$

$$\text{Sol. Expression } \sqrt{5 + 2\sqrt{6}} - \frac{1}{\sqrt{5 + 2\sqrt{6}}}$$

$$= \frac{(\sqrt{5 + 2\sqrt{6}})^2 - 1}{\sqrt{5 + 2\sqrt{6}}} = \frac{5 + 2\sqrt{6} - 1}{\sqrt{5 + 2\sqrt{6}}}$$

$$= \frac{4 + 2\sqrt{6}}{\sqrt{3} + \sqrt{2}} \times \left(\frac{\sqrt{3} - \sqrt{2}}{\sqrt{3} - \sqrt{2}}\right)$$

$$= 4\sqrt{3} + 6\sqrt{2} - 4\sqrt{2} - 4\sqrt{3} = 2\sqrt{2}$$

7. If $a = 64$ and $b = 289$, then the value of

$$(\sqrt{\sqrt{a} + \sqrt{b}} - \sqrt{\sqrt{b} - \sqrt{a}})^{1/2}$$

$$\text{Sol. } (\sqrt{\sqrt{64} + \sqrt{289}} - \sqrt{-\sqrt{64} + \sqrt{289}})^{1/2}$$

$$(\sqrt{8 + 17} - \sqrt{-8 + 17})^{1/2} = (5 - 3)^{1/2} = \sqrt{2}$$

Foundation

Questions

1. If $3^x - 3^{x-1} = 18$, then x^x is equal to
 (a) 3 (b) 8
 (c) 27 (d) 216
2. If $a^{2x+2} = 1$, where a is a positive real number other than 1, then $x = ?$
 (a) -2 (b) -1
 (c) 0 (d) 1
3. $\frac{[(12)^{-2}]^2}{[(12)^2]^{-2}} = ?$
 (a) 12 (b) 4.8
 (c) $\frac{12}{144}$ (d) 1
4. Value of ? in expression $7^{8.9} \div (343)^{1.7} \times (49)^{4.8} = 7^?$
 (a) 13.4 (b) 12.8
 (c) 11.4 (d) 9.6
5. If $\{(2^4)^{1/2}\}^? = 256$, find the value of '?'.
 (a) 1 (b) 2
 (c) 4 (d) 8
6. $(16)^9 \div (16)^4 \times 16^3 = (16)^?$
 (a) 6.75 (b) 8
 (c) 10 (d) 12
7. $(42 \times 229) \div (9261)^{1/3} = ?$
 (a) 448 (b) 452
 (c) 456 (d) 458
8. Evaluate $(0.00032)^{2/5}$.
 (a) $\frac{1}{625}$ (b) $\frac{1}{225}$
 (c) $\frac{1}{125}$ (d) $\frac{1}{25}$
9. If $\frac{\sqrt{7} - \sqrt{5}}{\sqrt{7} + \sqrt{5}} = a + b\sqrt{35}$, then the value of $(a - b)$ is:
 (a) 5 (b) 6
 (c) 8 (d) None of these
10. If $P = 124$, then $\sqrt[3]{P(P^2 + 3P + 3)} + 1 = ?$
 (a) 5 (b) 7
 (c) 123 (d) 125
11. If $\left(\frac{p}{q}\right)^{n-1} = \left(\frac{q}{p}\right)^{n-3}$, then the value of n is:
 (a) $\frac{1}{2}$ (b) $\frac{7}{2}$
 (c) 1 (d) 2
12. Value of ? in $\sqrt[3]{512} \div \sqrt[4]{16} + \sqrt{576} = ?$ is:
 (a) 24 (b) 31
 (c) 28 (d) 18
13. Value of $3 + \frac{1}{\sqrt{3}} + \frac{1}{3 + \sqrt{3}} + \frac{1}{\sqrt{3} - 3} - 3$ is:
 (a) $3 + \sqrt{3}$ (b) 3
 (c) 1 (d) 0
14. $16^{5/4} = ?$
 (a) 64 (b) 31
 (c) 32 (d) 33
15. $\left(\frac{32}{243}\right)^{-3/5} = ?$
 (a) $\frac{27}{8}$ (b) $\frac{27}{7}$
 (c) $\frac{27}{6}$ (d) $\frac{27}{2}$
16. Find the value of $(243)^{0.16} \times (243)^{0.04}$
 (a) 0.16 (b) $\frac{1}{3}$
 (c) 3 (d) 0.04
17. $17^{3.5} \times 17^{7.3} \div 17^{4.2} = 17^?$
 (a) 8.4 (b) 8
 (c) 6.6 (d) 6.4
18. If $289 = 17^{\frac{x}{5}}$, then $x = ?$
 (a) 16 (b) 8
 (c) 10 (d) $\frac{2}{5}$
19. $\left[\left\{\left(-\frac{1}{2}\right)^2\right\}^{-2}\right]^{-1} = ?$
 (a) $\frac{1}{16}$ (b) 16
 (c) $-\frac{1}{16}$ (d) -16

20. Find the value of $(10)^{200} \div (10)^{196}$.

- (a) 10000 (b) 1000
(c) 100 (d) 100000

21. If $\left(\frac{1}{5}\right)^{3a} = 0.008$, find the value of $(0.25)^a$.

- (a) 20.5 (b) 22.5
(c) 0.25 (d) 6.25

22. Value of $\sqrt{5+2\sqrt{6}} - \frac{1}{\sqrt{5-2\sqrt{6}}}$ is:

- (a) $2\sqrt{2}$ (b) 0
(c) $2\sqrt{3}$ (d) $\sqrt{5}-1$

23. $\frac{1}{1+x^{b-a}+x^{c-a}} + \frac{1}{1+x^{a-b}+x^{c-b}} + \frac{1}{1+x^{b-c}+x^{a-c}} = ?$

- (a) x^{a-b-c} (b) 1
(c) 0 (d) 3

24. $[P^{(b-c)}]^{(b+c)} \cdot [P^{(c-a)}]^{(c+a)} \cdot [P^{(a-b)}]^{(a+b)} = ?$

- (a) 0 (b) P^{abc}
(c) 1 (d) P^{a+b+c}

25. If $\sqrt{5+\sqrt[3]{x}} = 3$, then the value of x is:

- (a) 64 (b) 125
(c) 9 (d) 27

26. $\left[\left(\sqrt[5]{x^{-\frac{3}{5}}}\right)^{-\frac{5}{3}}\right]^5 = ?$

- (a) x^5 (b) x^{-5}
(c) x (d) $\frac{1}{x}$

27. $\left(\sqrt{56+\sqrt{56+\sqrt{56+\dots}}}\right) \div 2^2 = ?$

- (a) 0 (b) 1
(c) 2 (d) 8

28. If $a^x = b$, $b^y = c$ and $xyz = 1$, then what is the value of c^z ?

- (a) a (b) b
(c) ab (d) $\frac{a}{b}$

29. If $16 \times 8^{n+2} = 2^m$, then m is equal to:

- (a) n + 8 (b) 2n + 10
(c) 3n + 2 (d) 3n + 10

30. If $x = \frac{\sqrt{3}+1}{\sqrt{3}-1}$ and $y = \frac{\sqrt{3}-1}{\sqrt{3}+1}$, then $x^2 + y^2$ is equal to:

- (a) 14 (b) 13
(c) 15 (d) 10

Moderate

1. $\frac{16 \times 2^{n+1} - 4 \times 2^n}{16 \times 2^{n+2} - 2 \times 2^{n+2}} = ?$

- (a) 1 (b) 2
(c) $\frac{1}{2}$ (d) $\frac{1}{4}$

2. $\frac{2^{2^3} \div (2^2)^3 \times 2^{-2}}{4^{2^3} \div (4^2)^3 \times 4^{-2}} = ?$

- (a) 2 (b) $\frac{1}{2}$
(c) 1 (d) -2

3. $\frac{(0.6)^0 - (0.1)^{-1}}{\left(\frac{3}{2^3}\right)^{-1} \left(\frac{3}{2}\right)^3 + \left(-\frac{1}{3}\right)^{-1}} + \left(\frac{8}{27}\right)^{-\frac{1}{3}} = ?$

- (a) 1 (b) 0
(c) $\frac{1}{2}$ (d) $\frac{1}{4}$

4. If $\frac{(81)^{4x} \times (27)^x \times 9^7}{(729)^{x+2}} = 3^9$, then find the value of x.

- (a) $\frac{6}{13}$ (b) $\frac{5}{13}$

- (c) $\frac{8}{13}$ (d) $\frac{7}{13}$

5. If $2^a + 3^b = 17$ and $2^{a+2} - 3^{b+1} = 5$, the values of a and b are:

- (a) a = 2, b = 3 (b) a = 4, b = 6
(c) a = 3, b = 2 (d) a = -3, b = -2

6. $\left[\frac{3\sqrt{2}}{\sqrt{6}+\sqrt{3}} - \frac{4\sqrt{3}}{\sqrt{6}+\sqrt{2}} + \frac{\sqrt{6}}{\sqrt{3}+\sqrt{2}}\right]$ is simplified to

- (a) 0 (b) 1
(c) $\sqrt{3}$ (d) $\sqrt{6}$

7. Find the value of $\frac{2(\sqrt{2}+\sqrt{6})}{3\sqrt{2}+3}$.

- (a) $\frac{1}{3}$ (b) $\frac{2}{3}$

- (c) $-\frac{2}{3}$ (d) $\frac{4}{3}$

8. If $x = \frac{\sqrt{5}-2}{\sqrt{5}+2}$, then $x^4 + x^{-4}$ is
 (a) a surd
 (b) a rational number but not an integer
 (c) an integer
 (d) an irrational number but not a surd
9. The simplified value of $\sqrt{\frac{19+8\sqrt{3}}{7-4\sqrt{3}}}$ is:
 (a) $11-6\sqrt{3}$ (b) $11+6\sqrt{3}$
 (c) $10+5\sqrt{3}$ (d) $10-5\sqrt{3}$
10. The simplified value of $(28+10\sqrt{3})^{\frac{1}{2}} - (7-4\sqrt{3})^{\frac{1}{2}}$ is:
 (a) 1 (b) 2
 (c) 3 (d) 4
11. The simplified value of $\sqrt{6-4\sqrt{3}} + \sqrt{16-8\sqrt{3}}$ is:
 (a) $\sqrt{3}$ (b) $\sqrt{3}+1$
 (c) $\sqrt{3}-1$ (d) $\sqrt{3}+\sqrt{2}$
12. If $x = \sqrt{\frac{5+2\sqrt{6}}{5-2\sqrt{6}}}$, then the value of $x^2(x-10)^2$ is
 (a) 0 (b) 1
 (c) -1 (d) 2
13. The simplified value of $\frac{\sqrt{4-\sqrt{7}}}{\sqrt{8+3\sqrt{7}}-2\sqrt{2}}$ is:
 (a) 1 (b) 2
 (c) -1 (d) -2
14. $\frac{(625)^{6.25} \times (25)^{2.6}}{(625)^{6.75} \times (5)^{1.2}} = ?$
 (a) 5 (b) 10
 (c) 15 (d) 25
15. The simplified value of $\frac{2+\sqrt{3}}{2-\sqrt{3}}$ is:
 (a) $7+4\sqrt{3}$ (b) $7-4\sqrt{3}$
 (c) $7+2\sqrt{3}$ (d) $7-2\sqrt{3}$
16. The simplified value of $\frac{(0.3)^{\frac{1}{3}} \left(\frac{1}{27}\right)^{\frac{1}{4}} (9)^{\frac{1}{6}} (0.81)^{\frac{2}{3}}}{(0.9)^{\frac{2}{3}} (3)^{\frac{1}{2}} (243)^{\frac{1}{4}}}$ is:
 (a) 2.2 (b) 2.7
 (c) 2.4 (d) 2.6
17. $\frac{2^{n+4} - 2 \times 2^n}{2 \times 2^{n+3}} + 2^{-3} = ?$
 (a) 1 (b) 2
 (c) $\frac{1}{2}$ (d) $\frac{1}{3}$
18. If $10^{0.48} = x$, $10^{0.7} = y$ and $x^z = y^2$, then $z = ?$
 (a) $1\frac{11}{12}$ (b) $2\frac{11}{12}$
 (c) $3\frac{11}{12}$ (d) $-2\frac{11}{12}$
19. The simplified value of $(27)^{-\frac{2}{3}} + \left[\left(2^{-\frac{2}{3}}\right)^{-\frac{5}{3}}\right]^{\frac{9}{10}}$ is:
 (a) $\frac{11}{18}$ (b) $-\frac{11}{18}$
 (c) $\frac{17}{18}$ (d) $-\frac{17}{18}$
20. Find the value of $\sqrt{8+3\sqrt{7}} - \sqrt{7+3\sqrt{5}}$.
 (a) $\frac{\sqrt{14}+\sqrt{10}}{2}$ (b) $\frac{\sqrt{14}-\sqrt{10}}{2}$
 (c) $\frac{\sqrt{14}+\sqrt{10}}{4}$ (d) $\frac{\sqrt{14}-\sqrt{10}}{4}$
21. Find the value of $\sqrt{38+5\sqrt{3}} + \sqrt{3-\sqrt{5}}$.
 (a) $\frac{5\sqrt{6}-\sqrt{10}}{2}$ (b) $\frac{5\sqrt{6}+\sqrt{10}}{2}$
 (c) $\frac{5\sqrt{6}-\sqrt{10}}{4}$ (d) $\frac{5\sqrt{6}+\sqrt{10}}{4}$
22. Find the value of $\sqrt{4-\sqrt{7}} + \sqrt{8+3\sqrt{7}}$.
 (a) $\sqrt{2}(\sqrt{7}+1)$ (b) $\sqrt{2}+1$
 (c) 1 (d) $\sqrt{2}+2$
23. If $\sqrt{5} = 2.236$ and $\sqrt{10} = 3.162$, then the value of $\frac{15}{\sqrt{10} + \sqrt{20} + \sqrt{40} - \sqrt{5} - \sqrt{80}}$ is:
 (a) 4.398 (b) 5.398
 (c) 4.938 (d) 5.938
24. $\frac{(2^{2n} - 3 \cdot 2^{2n-2})(3^n - 2 \cdot 3^{n-2})}{3^{n-4}(4^{n+3} - 2^{2n})} = ?$
 (a) $\frac{1}{2}$ (b) $\frac{1}{4}$
 (c) $-\frac{1}{2}$ (d) $\frac{1}{6}$

- (a) $\sqrt{2}$ (b) $\sqrt{2} + 1$
(c) 1 (d) $\sqrt{2} + 2$

10. $\sqrt{11+4\sqrt{7}} - \sqrt{11-4\sqrt{7}} + \frac{\sqrt{8}}{\sqrt{33+10\sqrt{8}} - \sqrt{33-10\sqrt{8}}}$
= ?

- (a) $2\frac{1}{2}$ (b) $3\frac{1}{2}$
(c) $1\frac{1}{2}$ (d) $4\frac{1}{2}$

11. The simplified value of

$$\frac{26-15\sqrt{3}}{[5\sqrt{2}-\sqrt{38+5\sqrt{3}}]^2} + \frac{\sqrt{10}+\sqrt{18}}{\sqrt{8}+\sqrt{(3-\sqrt{5})}} \text{ is :}$$

- (a) $1\frac{1}{3}$ (b) $2\frac{1}{3}$
(c) $3\frac{1}{3}$ (d) $4\frac{1}{3}$

12. The simplified value of

$$(28-10\sqrt{3})^{\frac{1}{2}} - (7+4\sqrt{3})^{\frac{1}{2}} + \frac{\sqrt{7}}{\sqrt{16+6\sqrt{7}} - \sqrt{16-6\sqrt{7}}}$$

is:

- (a) $1\frac{1}{2}$ (b) $2\frac{1}{2}$
(c) $3\frac{1}{2}$ (d) $4\frac{1}{2}$

13. $\frac{4\sqrt{3}}{2-\sqrt{2}} - \frac{30}{4\sqrt{3}-\sqrt{18}} - \frac{\sqrt{18}}{3-2\sqrt{3}} = ?$

- (a) $2\sqrt{6}$ (b) $\sqrt{6}$
(c) $3\sqrt{6}$ (d) $4\sqrt{6}$

14. The simplified value of

$$\sqrt{\frac{(12.12)^2 - (8.12)^2}{(0.25)^2 + (0.25) \times (19.99)}} + \frac{\left[\left(8\frac{3}{4}\right)^{\frac{5}{2}}\right]^{\frac{8}{15}} \times 16^{\frac{3}{4}}}{\sqrt[3]{\left[\left\{(128^{-5})^{\frac{3}{7}}\right\}^{-\frac{1}{5}}\right]}} \text{ is :}$$

- (a) $3\frac{1}{2}$ (b) $2\frac{1}{2}$
(c) $4\frac{1}{2}$ (d) $5\frac{1}{2}$

15. $\frac{\sqrt[6]{2} \left[(625)^{\frac{3}{5}} \times (1024)^{-\frac{6}{5}} \div (25)^{\frac{3}{5}} \right]^{\frac{1}{2}}}{(\sqrt[3]{128})^{-\frac{5}{2}} \times (125)^{\frac{1}{5}}} + \frac{(10^3)^2 \div (10^{3^2})}{(10^2)^3 \div 10^{2^3}}$

- (a) 1.2 (b) 1.4
(c) 1.6 (d) 1.1

16. $(18-8\sqrt{2})^{\frac{1}{2}} + (6-4\sqrt{2})^{\frac{1}{2}} + \frac{\sqrt{3}}{\sqrt{19+8\sqrt{3}} - \sqrt{19-8\sqrt{3}}} =$

- (a) $\frac{11-\sqrt{2}}{2}$ (b) $\frac{11+\sqrt{2}}{2}$
(c) $\frac{11-2\sqrt{2}}{2}$ (d) $\frac{11+2\sqrt{2}}{2}$

17. $\sqrt{7+4\sqrt{3}} - \sqrt{28+10\sqrt{3}} + \frac{\sqrt{11}}{\sqrt{20+6\sqrt{11}} + \sqrt{20-6\sqrt{11}}} =$

- (a) $2\frac{1}{2}$ (b) $1\frac{1}{2}$
(c) $-1\frac{1}{2}$ (d) $-2\frac{1}{2}$

18. $\frac{1}{\sqrt{11-2\sqrt{30}}} - \frac{3}{\sqrt{7-2\sqrt{10}}} - \frac{4}{\sqrt{8+4\sqrt{3}}} = ?$

- (a) 0 (b) 1
(c) -1 (d) $-2\sqrt{3}$

19. If $x = \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}$, then $\frac{\sqrt{1+x} + \sqrt{1-x}}{\sqrt{1+x} - \sqrt{1-x}} = ?$

- (a) $-\sqrt{3}$ (b) $\sqrt{3}$
(c) $-\sqrt{2}$ (d) $\sqrt{2}$

20. If $x = \frac{\sqrt{a+2b} + \sqrt{a-2b}}{\sqrt{a+2b} - \sqrt{a-2b}}$, then the value of

$bx^2 - ax + b$ is :

- (a) 0 (b) -1
(c) 1 (d) -2

Previous Year (Memory Based)

1. If $\left(\frac{3}{5}\right)^3 \left(\frac{3}{5}\right)^{-6} = \left(\frac{3}{5}\right)^{2x-1}$, then x is equal to
 (a) -2 (b) 2
 (c) -1 (d) 1
2. If $\frac{\sqrt{7}-2}{\sqrt{7}+2} = a\sqrt{7} + b$, then the value of a is
 (a) $\frac{11}{3}$ (b) $-\frac{4}{3}$
 (c) $\frac{4}{3}$ (d) $-\frac{4\sqrt{7}}{3}$
3. If $x = \frac{\sqrt{5}+\sqrt{3}}{\sqrt{5}-\sqrt{3}}$ and $y = \frac{\sqrt{5}-\sqrt{3}}{\sqrt{5}+\sqrt{3}}$ then (x + y) equals:
 (a) 8 (b) 16
 (c) $2\sqrt{15}$ (d) $2(\sqrt{5}+\sqrt{3})$
4. If $\sqrt{2} = 1.414$, the square root of $\frac{\sqrt{2}-1}{\sqrt{2}+1}$ is nearest to
 (a) 0.172 (b) 0.414
 (c) 0.586 (d) 1.414
5. For what value(s) of a is $x + \frac{1}{4}\sqrt{x} + a^2$ is a perfect square?
 (a) $\pm\frac{1}{18}$ (b) $\frac{1}{8}$
 (c) $-\frac{1}{5}$ (d) $\frac{1}{4}$
6. Which of the following numbers is the least ?
 $(0.5)^2, \sqrt{0.49}, \sqrt[3]{0.008}, 0.23$
 (a) $(0.5)^2$ (b) $\sqrt{0.49}$
 (c) $\sqrt[3]{0.008}$ (d) 0.23
7. Arrange the following in descending order :
 $\sqrt[3]{4}, \sqrt{2}, \sqrt[6]{3}, \sqrt[4]{5}$
 (a) $\sqrt[3]{4} > \sqrt[4]{5} > \sqrt{2} > \sqrt[6]{3}$
 (b) $\sqrt[4]{5} > \sqrt[3]{4} > \sqrt[6]{3} > \sqrt{2}$
 (c) $\sqrt{2} > \sqrt[6]{3} > \sqrt[3]{4} > \sqrt[4]{5}$
 (d) $\sqrt{2} > \sqrt[3]{4} > \sqrt[6]{3} > \sqrt[4]{5}$
8. $\left[\frac{\sqrt{3}+\sqrt{2}}{\sqrt{3}-\sqrt{2}} - \frac{\sqrt{3}-\sqrt{2}}{\sqrt{3}+\sqrt{2}} \right]$ simplifies to
 (a) $2\sqrt{6}$ (b) $4\sqrt{6}$
 (c) $2\sqrt{3}$ (d) $3\sqrt{2}$
9. By how much does $(\sqrt{12} + \sqrt{18})$ exceed $(2\sqrt{3} + 2\sqrt{2})$
 (a) 2 (b) $\sqrt{3}$
 (c) $\sqrt{2}$ (d) 3
10. The greatest number among $\sqrt{5}, \sqrt[3]{4}, \sqrt[5]{2}, \sqrt[7]{3}$ is:
 (a) $\sqrt[3]{4}$ (b) $\sqrt[7]{3}$
 (c) $\sqrt{5}$ (d) $\sqrt[5]{2}$
11. If $\sqrt[7]{7\sqrt{7}\sqrt{7}\sqrt{7}\dots} = (343)^{y-1}$, then y is equal to
 (a) $\frac{2}{3}$ (b) 1
 (c) $\frac{4}{3}$ (d) $\frac{3}{4}$
12. $\frac{1}{\sqrt[3]{4} + \sqrt[3]{2} + 1}$ is equal to
 (a) $\sqrt[3]{2} + 1$ (b) $\sqrt[3]{2} - 1$
 (c) $-\sqrt[3]{2} - 1$ (d) $1 - \sqrt[3]{2}$
13. $\frac{1}{\sqrt{1}+\sqrt{2}} + \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}+\sqrt{3}} + \frac{1}{\sqrt{3}+\sqrt{4}} + \dots + \frac{1}{\sqrt{99}+\sqrt{100}}$ is equal to
 (a) $10 - \sqrt{99}$ (b) $\sqrt{2} - 10$
 (c) 7 (d) 9
14. If $\sqrt{6} \times \sqrt{15} = x\sqrt{10}$, then the value of x is
 (a) 3 (b) ± 3
 (c) $\sqrt{3}$ (d) $\sqrt{6}$
15. The largest among the numbers
 $\sqrt{7} - \sqrt{5}, \sqrt{5} - \sqrt{3}, \sqrt{9} - \sqrt{7}, \sqrt{11} - \sqrt{9}$ is :
 (a) $\sqrt{7} - \sqrt{5}$ (b) $\sqrt{5} - \sqrt{3}$
 (c) $\sqrt{9} - \sqrt{7}$ (d) $\sqrt{11} - \sqrt{9}$
16. The largest among the numbers $(0.1)^2, \sqrt{0.0121}, 0.12$ and $\sqrt{0.0004}$ is :

- (a) $(0.1)^2$ (b) $\sqrt{0.0121}$
 (c) 0.12 (d) $\sqrt{0.0004}$
17. $\sqrt{6 + \sqrt{6 + \sqrt{6 + \dots}}}$ is equal to
 (a) 2 (b) 5
 (c) 4 (d) 3
18. The value of $\frac{(81)^{3.6} \times (9)^{2.7}}{(81)^{4.2} \times (3)}$ is :
 (a) 3 (b) 6
 (c) 9 (d) 8.2
19. If $a = \frac{\sqrt{3} - \sqrt{2}}{\sqrt{3} + \sqrt{2}}$, $b = \frac{\sqrt{3} + \sqrt{2}}{\sqrt{3} - \sqrt{2}}$, then the value of $\frac{a^2}{b} + \frac{b^2}{a}$ is :
 (a) 900 (b) 970
 (c) 1030 (d) 930
20. If $2\sqrt{x} = \frac{\sqrt{5} + \sqrt{3}}{\sqrt{5} - \sqrt{3}} - \frac{\sqrt{5} - \sqrt{3}}{\sqrt{5} + \sqrt{3}}$, then the value of x is :
 (a) 6 (b) 30
 (c) $\sqrt{15}$ (d) 15
21. If $\sqrt{3} = 1.732$, the value of $\frac{3 + \sqrt{6}}{5\sqrt{3} - 2\sqrt{12} - \sqrt{32} + \sqrt{50}}$ is :
 (a) 4.899 (b) 2.551
 (c) 1.414 (d) 1.732
22. $\sqrt{10 + 2\sqrt{6} + 2\sqrt{10} + 2\sqrt{15}}$ is equal to
 (a) $(\sqrt{2} + \sqrt{3} - \sqrt{5})$ (b) $(\sqrt{3} + \sqrt{5} - \sqrt{2})$
 (c) $(\sqrt{2} + \sqrt{5} - \sqrt{3})$ (d) $(\sqrt{2} + \sqrt{3} + \sqrt{5})$
23. The value of $\sqrt{\frac{(\sqrt{12} - \sqrt{8})(\sqrt{3} + \sqrt{2})}{5 + \sqrt{24}}}$ is :
 (a) $\sqrt{6} - \sqrt{2}$ (b) $\sqrt{6} + \sqrt{2}$
 (c) $\sqrt{6} - 2$ (d) $2 - \sqrt{6}$
24. If $a = \frac{2 + \sqrt{3}}{2 - \sqrt{3}}$ and $b = \frac{2 - \sqrt{3}}{2 + \sqrt{3}}$, then the value of $(a^2 + b^2 + ab)$
 (a) 169 (b) 195
 (c) 168 (d) 196
25. $\frac{\sqrt{7}}{\sqrt{16 + 6\sqrt{7}} - \sqrt{16 - 6\sqrt{7}}}$ is equal to
 (a) $\frac{1}{2}$ (b) $\frac{1}{3}$
 (c) $\frac{1}{4}$ (d) $\frac{1}{5}$
26. By how much does $\sqrt{12} + \sqrt{18}$ exceed $\sqrt{3} + \sqrt{2}$?
 (a) $2(\sqrt{3} - \sqrt{2})$ (b) $2(\sqrt{3} + \sqrt{2})$
 (c) $\sqrt{3} + 2\sqrt{2}$ (d) $\sqrt{2} - 4\sqrt{3}$
27. When simplified $(256)^{-(4^{-3/2})}$ is
 (a) 8 (b) $\frac{1}{8}$
 (c) 2 (d) $\frac{1}{2}$
28. The largest among the numbers 0.9, $\sqrt{0.9}$, $0.\bar{9}$ is
 (a) 0.9 (b) $(0.9)^2$
 (c) $\sqrt{0.9}$ (d) $0.\bar{9}$
29. $\sqrt[3]{0.004096}$ is equal to
 (a) 4 (b) 0.4
 (c) 0.04 (d) 0.004
30. The ascending order of $(2.89)^{0.5}$, $2 - (0.5)^2$, $\sqrt{3}$ and $\sqrt[3]{0.008}$ is
 (a) $2 - (0.5)^2$, $\sqrt{3}$, $\sqrt[3]{0.008}$, $(2.89)^{0.5}$
 (b) $\sqrt[3]{0.008}$, $(2.89)^{0.5}$, $\sqrt{3}$, $2 - (0.5)^2$
 (c) $\sqrt[3]{0.008}$, $\sqrt{3}$, $(2.89)^{0.5}$, $2 - (0.5)^2$
 (d) $\sqrt{3}$, $\sqrt[3]{0.008}$, $2 - (0.5)^2$, $(2.89)^{0.5}$

Foundation

Solutions

1. (c); $3^{x-1}(3-1) = 18$
 $3^{x-1} = 9 = 3^2$
 $x - 1 = 2 \Rightarrow x = 3$ so, $x^x = 27$
2. (b); $a^{2x+2} = a^0$
 $2x = -2 \Rightarrow x = -1$
3. (d); $\frac{12^{-4}}{12^{-4}} = 1$

$$4. \quad (a); 7^? = \frac{7^{8.9} \times (7^2)^{4.8}}{(7^3)^{1.7}} = \frac{7^{18.5}}{7^{5.1}} = 7^{13.4}$$

$$? = 13.4$$

$$5. \quad (c); 2^{4 \times \frac{1}{2} \times ?} = 2^8$$

$$? = 4$$

$$6. \quad (b); (16)^? = \frac{(16)^9 \times (16)^3}{(16)^4} = 16^{9+3-4} = 16^8$$

$$? = 8$$

$$7. \quad (d); \frac{(42 \times 229)}{(9261)^{\frac{1}{3}}} = \frac{42 \times 229}{21} = 458$$

$$8. \quad (d); \left(\frac{32}{100000}\right)^{\frac{2}{5}} = \left\{\left(\frac{2}{10}\right)^5\right\}^{\frac{2}{5}} = \left(\frac{1}{5}\right)^2 = \frac{1}{25}$$

$$9. \quad (d); \frac{\sqrt{7} - \sqrt{5}}{\sqrt{7} + \sqrt{5}} = \frac{(\sqrt{7} - \sqrt{5})(\sqrt{7} - \sqrt{5})}{2} = 6 - \sqrt{35}$$

$$\text{on comparison, } a = 6 \text{ and } b = -1$$

$$a - b = 6 - (-1) = 7$$

$$10. \quad (d); \sqrt[3]{P(P^2 + 3P + 3) + 1} = \sqrt[3]{P^3 + 3P^2 + 3P + 1}$$

$$= \sqrt[3]{(P+1)^3} = P+1$$

$$P = 124, \quad P+1 = 125$$

$$11. \quad (d); \left(\frac{p}{q}\right)^{n-1} = \left(\frac{p}{q}\right)^{3-n}$$

$$n-1 = 3-n, \quad 2n = 4 \Rightarrow n = 2$$

$$12. \quad (c); ? = 8 \div 2 + 24 = 28$$

$$13. \quad (d); 3 + \frac{1}{\sqrt{3}} + \frac{(3-\sqrt{3})}{(3+\sqrt{3})(3-\sqrt{3})} + \frac{(\sqrt{3}+3)}{(\sqrt{3}-3)(\sqrt{3}+3)} - 3$$

$$= 3 + \frac{1}{\sqrt{3}} + \frac{3-\sqrt{3}-\sqrt{3}-3}{6} - 3 = 3 + \frac{1}{\sqrt{3}} - \frac{1}{\sqrt{3}} - 3 = 0$$

$$14. \quad (c); (16)^{\frac{5}{4}} = (2^4)^{\frac{5}{4}} = 32$$

$$15. \quad (a); \left(\frac{243}{32}\right)^{\frac{3}{5}} = \left(\frac{3^5}{2^5}\right)^{\frac{3}{5}} = \frac{27}{8}$$

$$16. \quad (c); (243)^{0.2} = (3^5)^{0.2} = 3$$

$$17. \quad (c); 17^{3.5 + 7.3 - 4.2} = 17^x$$

$$x = 6.6$$

$$18. \quad (c); 17^2 = 17^{\frac{x}{5}} \Rightarrow \frac{x}{5} = 2 \Rightarrow x = 10$$

$$19. \quad (a); \left[\left\{\frac{1}{4}\right\}^{-2}\right]^{-1} = \left\{\frac{1}{16}\right\}^{-1} = 16^{-1} = \frac{1}{16}$$

$$20. \quad (a); 10^{200-196} = 10000$$

$$21. \quad (c); \left(\frac{1}{5}\right)^{3a} = 0.008 = \frac{8}{1000} = \left(\frac{1}{5}\right)^3$$

$$3a = 3 \Rightarrow a = 1$$

$$(0.25)^a = 0.25$$

$$22. \quad (b); \sqrt{(\sqrt{3})^2 + (\sqrt{2})^2 + 2\sqrt{3}\sqrt{2}} - \frac{1}{\sqrt{(\sqrt{3})^2 + (\sqrt{2})^2 - 2\sqrt{3}\sqrt{2}}}$$

$$= \sqrt{3} + \sqrt{2} - \frac{1}{\sqrt{3} - \sqrt{2}} = \sqrt{3} + \sqrt{2} - \sqrt{3} - \sqrt{2} = 0$$

$$23. \quad (b); \frac{1}{1 + \frac{x^b}{x^a} + \frac{x^c}{x^a}} + \frac{1}{1 + \frac{x^a}{x^b} + \frac{x^c}{x^b}} + \frac{1}{1 + \frac{x^b}{x^c} + \frac{x^a}{x^c}}$$

$$= \frac{x^a}{x^a + x^b + x^c} + \frac{x^b}{x^a + x^b + x^c} + \frac{x^c}{x^a + x^b + x^c} = 1$$

$$24. \quad (c); P^{b^2-c^2} \cdot P^{c^2-a^2} \cdot P^{a^2-b^2} = P^{b^2-c^2+c^2-a^2+a^2-b^2} = 1$$

$$25. \quad (a); \sqrt{5 + \sqrt[3]{x}} = 3$$

$$\sqrt[3]{x} = 9 - 5 \Rightarrow x = 4^3 = 64$$

$$26. \quad (c); \left[\left\{x^{-\frac{3}{5} \times \frac{1}{5}}\right\}^{-\frac{5}{3}}\right]^5 = x^{\frac{-3 \times 1 \times -5}{5 \times 3 \times 5}} = x$$

$$27. \quad (c); 56 = 8 \times 7$$

$$\text{so, } \sqrt{56 + \sqrt{56 + \sqrt{56 + \dots}}} = 8$$

$$= 8 \div 2^2 = 2$$

$$28. \quad (a); b = a^x$$

$$b^y = a^{xy}$$

$$b^{yz} = a^{xyz}$$

$$c^z = a$$

$$29. \quad (d); 2^4 \times 2^{3(n+2)} = 2^m$$

$$2^m = 2^{(3n+10)}$$

$$3n + 10 = m$$

$$30. \quad (a); x^2 + y^2 = \left(\frac{\sqrt{3}+1}{\sqrt{3}-1}\right)^2 + \left(\frac{\sqrt{3}-1}{\sqrt{3}+1}\right)^2$$

$$= \frac{4+2\sqrt{3}}{4-2\sqrt{3}} + \frac{4-2\sqrt{3}}{4+2\sqrt{3}}$$

$$= \frac{(4+2\sqrt{3})^2 + (4-2\sqrt{3})^2}{(4-2\sqrt{3})(4+2\sqrt{3})}$$

$$= \frac{16+12+16\sqrt{3}+16+12-16\sqrt{3}}{16-12} = \frac{56}{4} = 14$$

Moderate

$$\begin{aligned}
 1. \quad (c); \text{ Expression} &= \frac{16 \times 2^{n+1} - 4 \times 2^n}{16 \times 2^{n+2} - 2 \times 2^{n+2}} \\
 &= \frac{2^4 \times 2^{n+1} - 2^2 \times 2^n}{2^4 \times 2^{n+2} - 2 \times 2^{n+2}} = \frac{2^{n+5} - 2^{n+2}}{2^{n+6} - 2^{n+3}} \\
 &= \frac{2^{n+5} - 2^{n+2}}{2 \times 2^{n+5} - 2 \times 2^{n+2}} = \frac{2^{n+5} - 2^{n+2}}{2(2^{n+5} - 2^{n+2})} = \frac{1}{2}
 \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned}
 2. \quad (c); \text{ Expression} &= \frac{2^{2^3} \div (2^2)^3 \times 2^{-2}}{4^{2^3} \div (4^2)^3 \times 4^{-2}} \\
 &= \frac{2^{2 \times 2 \times 2} \div 2^{2 \times 3} \times 2^{-2}}{4^{2 \times 2 \times 2} \div 4^{2 \times 3} \times 4^{-2}} \\
 &= \frac{2^8 \div 2^6 \times 2^{-2}}{4^8 \div 4^6 \times 4^{-2}} = \frac{2^8 \times \frac{1}{2^6} \times \frac{1}{2^2}}{4^8 \times \frac{1}{4^6} \times \frac{1}{4^2}} = 1
 \end{aligned}$$

$$3. \quad (b); \text{ Expression}$$

$$\begin{aligned}
 &= \frac{(0.6)^0 - (0.1)^{-1}}{\left(\frac{3}{2}\right)^{-1} \left(\frac{3}{2}\right)^3 + \left(-\frac{1}{3}\right)^{-1}} + \left(\frac{8}{27}\right)^{-\frac{1}{3}} \\
 &= \frac{1 - \left(\frac{1}{10}\right)^{-1}}{\left(\frac{3}{8}\right)^{-1} \left(\frac{3}{2}\right)^3 + \left(-\frac{1}{3}\right)^{-1}} + \left(\frac{8}{27}\right)^{-\frac{1}{3}} \\
 &= \frac{1 - 10}{\frac{8}{3} \times \frac{27}{8} + (-3)} + \left(\frac{27}{8}\right)^{\frac{1}{3}} \\
 &= \frac{-9}{9 - 3} + \left[\left(\frac{3}{2}\right)^3\right]^{\frac{1}{3}} = -\frac{9}{6} + \frac{3}{2} = -\frac{3}{2} + \frac{3}{2} = 0
 \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned}
 4. \quad (d); \frac{(81)^{4x} \times (27)^x \times 9^7}{(729)^{x+2}} &= 3^9 \\
 \Rightarrow \frac{(3^4)^{4x} \times (3^3)^x \times (3^2)^7}{(3^6)^{x+2}} &= 3^9 \\
 \Rightarrow \frac{3^{16x} \times 3^{3x} \times 3^{14}}{3^{6x+12}} &= 3^9 \\
 \Rightarrow \frac{3^{16x+3x+14}}{3^{6x+12}} &= 3^9 \Rightarrow 3^{19x+14-6x-12} = 3^9
 \end{aligned}$$

$$3^{13x+2} = 3^9 \Rightarrow 13x + 2 = 9$$

$$13x = 9 - 2 = 7 \Rightarrow x = \frac{7}{13}$$

$$5. \quad (c); \text{ The equations are}$$

$$2^a + 3^b = 17 \text{ and } 2^a \times 2^2 - 3^b \times 3 = 5$$

$$\text{Let } x = 2^a \text{ and } y = 3^b$$

$$\text{then, } x + y = 17 \quad \dots (i)$$

$$\text{and } 4x - 3y = 5 \quad \dots (ii)$$

$$\text{By equation (i)} \times 3 + \text{(ii),}$$

$$3x + 3y = 51$$

$$4x - 3y = 5$$

$$\hline 7x = 56$$

$$\text{From equation (i),}$$

$$y = 17 - x = 17 - 8 = 9$$

$$\therefore x = 8 \text{ and } y = 9$$

$$\therefore x = 2^a = 8 \Rightarrow 2^a = 2^3 \Rightarrow a = 3$$

$$\text{and } y = 3^b = 9 \Rightarrow 3^b = 3^2 \Rightarrow b = 2$$

$$\therefore a = 3 \text{ and } b = 2$$

$$6. \quad (a); \text{ Expression} = \frac{3\sqrt{2}}{\sqrt{6}+\sqrt{3}} - \frac{4\sqrt{3}}{\sqrt{6}+\sqrt{2}} + \frac{\sqrt{6}}{\sqrt{3}+\sqrt{2}}$$

$$\begin{aligned}
 &= \frac{3\sqrt{2}}{\sqrt{6}+\sqrt{3}} \times \frac{\sqrt{6}-\sqrt{3}}{\sqrt{6}-\sqrt{3}} - \frac{4\sqrt{3}}{\sqrt{6}+\sqrt{2}} \times \frac{\sqrt{6}-\sqrt{2}}{\sqrt{6}-\sqrt{2}} \\
 &\quad + \frac{\sqrt{6}}{\sqrt{3}+\sqrt{2}} \times \frac{\sqrt{3}-\sqrt{2}}{\sqrt{3}-\sqrt{2}}
 \end{aligned}$$

[Rationalising the respective denominators]

$$\begin{aligned}
 &= \frac{3\sqrt{2}(\sqrt{6}-\sqrt{3})}{6-3} - \frac{4\sqrt{3}(\sqrt{6}-\sqrt{2})}{6-2} + \frac{\sqrt{6}(\sqrt{3}-\sqrt{2})}{3-2} \\
 &= \sqrt{2}(\sqrt{6}-\sqrt{3}) - \sqrt{3}(\sqrt{6}-\sqrt{2}) + \sqrt{6}(\sqrt{3}-\sqrt{2}) \\
 &= \sqrt{12} - \sqrt{6} - \sqrt{18} + \sqrt{6} + \sqrt{18} - \sqrt{12} = 0
 \end{aligned}$$

$$7. \quad (d); \text{ Let } x = \frac{2(\sqrt{2}+\sqrt{6})}{3\sqrt{2}+\sqrt{3}}$$

$$\text{Squaring both sides, } x^2 = \left[\frac{2(\sqrt{2}+\sqrt{6})}{3\sqrt{2}+\sqrt{3}} \right]^2$$

$$x^2 = \frac{4(\sqrt{2}+\sqrt{6})^2}{(3\sqrt{2}+\sqrt{3})^2} \Rightarrow x^2 = \frac{4(\sqrt{2}+\sqrt{6})^2}{9(2+\sqrt{3})}$$

$$x^2 = \frac{4(2+6+2 \times \sqrt{2} \times \sqrt{6})}{9(2+\sqrt{3})}$$

$$x^2 = \frac{4(8+2\sqrt{12})}{9(2+\sqrt{3})} \Rightarrow x^2 = \frac{4(8+2\sqrt{2^2 \times 3})}{9(2+\sqrt{3})}$$

$$x^2 = \frac{4(8+4\sqrt{3})}{9(2+\sqrt{3})} \Rightarrow x^2 = \frac{16(2+\sqrt{3})}{9(2+\sqrt{3})} = \frac{16}{9}$$

$$x = \frac{4}{3}$$

8. (c); $x = \frac{\sqrt{5}-2}{\sqrt{5}+2}$

$$= \frac{(\sqrt{5}-2)^2}{(\sqrt{5}+2)(\sqrt{5}-2)} = \frac{5+4-4\sqrt{5}}{5-4} = 9-4\sqrt{5}$$

$$\therefore \frac{1}{x} = 9+4\sqrt{5}, \quad x^4 + x^{-4} = x^4 + \frac{1}{x^4}$$

$$= \left(x^2 + \frac{1}{x^2}\right)^2 - 2 = \left[\left(x + \frac{1}{x}\right)^2 - 2\right]^2 - 2$$

$$= \left[(9+4\sqrt{5}+9-4\sqrt{5})^2 - 2\right]^2 - 2$$

$$= [(18)^2 - 2]^2 - 2 = (322)^2 - 2 = 103682 \text{ (integer)}$$

9. (b); Expression = $\sqrt{\frac{19+8\sqrt{3}}{7-4\sqrt{3}}}$

$$= \sqrt{\frac{19+2 \times 4 \times \sqrt{3}}{7-2 \times 2 \times \sqrt{3}}} = \sqrt{\frac{16+3+2 \times 4 \times \sqrt{3}}{4+3-2 \times 2 \times \sqrt{3}}}$$

$$= \sqrt{\frac{(4)^2 + (\sqrt{3})^2 + 2 \times 4 \times \sqrt{3}}{(2)^2 + (\sqrt{3})^2 - 2 \times 2 \times \sqrt{3}}} = \sqrt{\frac{(4+\sqrt{3})^2}{(2-\sqrt{3})^2}}$$

$$[\because (a \pm b)^2 = a^2 + b^2 \pm 2ab]$$

$$= \frac{4+\sqrt{3}}{2-\sqrt{3}}$$

Rationalising the denominator.

$$= \frac{(4+\sqrt{3}) \times (2+\sqrt{3})}{(2-\sqrt{3})(2+\sqrt{3})} = \frac{8+2\sqrt{3}+4\sqrt{3}+3}{4-3}$$

$$= 11+6\sqrt{3}$$

10. (c); First term = $(28+10\sqrt{3})^{\frac{1}{2}}$

$$= (28+2 \times 5 \times \sqrt{3})^{\frac{1}{2}}$$

$$= (25+3+2 \times 5 \times \sqrt{3})^{\frac{1}{2}}$$

$$= [(5)^2 + (\sqrt{3})^2 + 2 \times 5 \times \sqrt{3}]^{\frac{1}{2}}$$

$$= [(5+\sqrt{3})^2]^{\frac{1}{2}} = 5+\sqrt{3}$$

$$\text{Second term} = (7-4\sqrt{3})^{\frac{1}{2}} = (7-2 \times 2 \times \sqrt{3})^{\frac{1}{2}}$$

$$= (4+3-2 \times 2 \times \sqrt{3})^{\frac{1}{2}}$$

$$= [(2)^2 + (\sqrt{3})^2 - 2 \times 2 \times \sqrt{3}]^{\frac{1}{2}}$$

$$= [(2-\sqrt{3})^2]^{\frac{1}{2}} = (2-\sqrt{3})^{2 \times \frac{1}{2}}$$

$$= (2-\sqrt{3})^{-1} = \frac{1}{(2-\sqrt{3})}$$

$$= \frac{1 \times (2+\sqrt{3})}{(2-\sqrt{3})(2+\sqrt{3})} = \frac{(2+\sqrt{3})}{4-3} = 2+\sqrt{3}$$

$\therefore$ Expression

$$= (5+\sqrt{3}) - (2+\sqrt{3}) = 5+\sqrt{3}-2-\sqrt{3} = 3$$

11. (c); Expression = $\sqrt{6-4\sqrt{3}+\sqrt{16-8\sqrt{3}}}$

$$= \sqrt{6-4\sqrt{3}+\sqrt{16-2 \times 2 \times \sqrt{3} \times 2}}$$

$$= \sqrt{6-4\sqrt{3}+\sqrt{12+4-2 \times 2 \times \sqrt{3} \times 2}}$$

$$= \sqrt{6-4\sqrt{3}+\sqrt{(2\sqrt{3})^2 + (2)^2 - 2 \times 2 \times \sqrt{3} \times 2}}$$

$$= \sqrt{6-4\sqrt{3}+\sqrt{(2\sqrt{3}-2)^2}}$$

$$= \sqrt{6-4\sqrt{3}+2\sqrt{3}-2}$$

$$= \sqrt{4-2\sqrt{3}} = \sqrt{3+1-2 \times \sqrt{3} \times 1}$$

$$= \sqrt{(\sqrt{3})^2 + (1)^2 - 2 \times \sqrt{3} \times 1}$$

$$= \sqrt{(\sqrt{3}-1)^2} = \sqrt{3}-1$$

12. (b); $x = \sqrt{\frac{5+2\sqrt{6}}{5-2\sqrt{6}}}$ Rationalising,

$$x = \sqrt{\frac{5+2\sqrt{6}}{5-2\sqrt{6}} \times \frac{5+2\sqrt{6}}{5+2\sqrt{6}}}$$

$$= \sqrt{\frac{(5+2\sqrt{6})^2}{25-24}} = 5+2\sqrt{6}$$

$$\therefore x^2(x-10)^2$$

$$= (5+2\sqrt{6})^2 (5+2\sqrt{6}-10)^2$$

$$= (5+2\sqrt{6})^2 (2\sqrt{6}-5)^2$$

$$= (25+24+20\sqrt{6})(24+25-20\sqrt{6})$$

$$= (49+20\sqrt{6})(49-20\sqrt{6})$$

$$= (49)^2 - (20\sqrt{6})^2 = 2401 - 2400 = 1$$

$$13. (a); \frac{\sqrt{4-\sqrt{7}}}{\sqrt{8+3\sqrt{7}}-2\sqrt{2}} = \frac{\sqrt{8-2\sqrt{7}}}{\sqrt{16+6\sqrt{7}}-4}$$

(Multiplying numerator and denominator by $\sqrt{2}$)

$$= \frac{\sqrt{(1)^2 + (\sqrt{7})^2 - 2 \times 1 \times \sqrt{7}}}{\sqrt{(3)^2 + (\sqrt{7})^2 + 2.3 \cdot \sqrt{7}} - 4}$$

$$\left\{ \because 8 = 1 + 7 = 1^2 + (\sqrt{7})^2 \text{ and } 16 = 9 + 7 = 3^2 + (\sqrt{7})^2 \right\}$$

$$= \frac{\sqrt{(\sqrt{7}-1)^2}}{\sqrt{(\sqrt{7}+3)^2} - 4} \quad \left\{ \because a^2 + b^2 - 2ab = (a-b)^2 \right\}$$

$$= \frac{\sqrt{7}-1}{\sqrt{7}+3-4} = \frac{\sqrt{7}-1}{\sqrt{7}-1} = 1$$

$$14. (d); \text{Expression} = \frac{(625)^{6.25} \times (25)^{2.6}}{(625)^{6.75} \times (5)^{1.2}}$$

$$= \frac{(5^4)^{6.25} \times (5^2)^{2.6}}{(5^4)^{6.75} \times (5)^{1.2}} = \frac{(5)^{4 \times 6.25} \times (5)^{2 \times 2.6}}{(5)^{4 \times 6.75} \times (5)^{1.2}}$$

$$= \frac{(5)^{25} \times (5)^{5.2}}{(5)^{27} \times (5)^{1.2}} = \frac{(5)^{25+5.2}}{(5)^{27+1.2}} = \frac{(5)^{30.2}}{(5)^{28.2}}$$

$$= (5)^{30.2-28.2} = (5)^2 = 25$$

$$15. (a); \text{Expression} = \frac{2+\sqrt{3}}{2-\sqrt{3}}$$

$$= \frac{(2+\sqrt{3}) \times (2+\sqrt{3})}{(2-\sqrt{3}) \times (2+\sqrt{3})}$$

[Multiplying N^r and D^r by $(2+\sqrt{3})$]

$$= \frac{(2+\sqrt{3})^2}{(2)^2 - (\sqrt{3})^2} \quad [\because (a+b)(a-b) = a^2 - b^2]$$

$$= \frac{4+3+2 \times 2\sqrt{3}}{4-3} = 7+4\sqrt{3}$$

$$16. (b); \text{Expression} = \frac{(0.3)^{\frac{1}{3}} \left(\frac{1}{27} \right)^{\frac{1}{4}} (9)^{\frac{1}{6}} (0.81)^{\frac{2}{3}}}{(0.9)^{\frac{2}{3}} (3)^{-\frac{1}{2}} (243)^{-\frac{1}{4}}}$$

$$= \frac{(0.3)^{\frac{1}{3}} (9)^{\frac{1}{6}} (0.81)^{\frac{2}{3}} \times (3)^{\frac{1}{2}} (243)^{\frac{1}{4}}}{(0.9)^{\frac{2}{3}} \times (27)^{\frac{1}{4}}}$$

$$= \frac{(0.3)^{\frac{1}{3}} (3^2)^{\frac{1}{6}} (0.9)^{2 \times \frac{2}{3}} \times (3)^{\frac{1}{2}} (3^5)^{\frac{1}{4}}}{(0.9)^{\frac{2}{3}} \times (3^3)^{\frac{1}{4}}}$$

$$= \frac{(0.3)^{\frac{1}{3}} 3^{\frac{1}{3}} \times (0.9)^{\frac{4}{3}} \times 3^{\frac{1}{2}} \times 3^{\frac{5}{4}}}{(0.9)^{\frac{2}{3}} \times 3^{\frac{3}{4}}}$$

$$= (0.3)^{\frac{1}{3}} \times (0.9)^{\frac{4}{3} - \frac{2}{3}} \times 3^{\frac{1}{2} + \frac{5}{4} - \frac{3}{4}}$$

$$= (0.3)^{\frac{1}{3}} \times (0.9)^{\frac{2}{3}} \times 3^{\frac{4+6+5-9}{12}}$$

$$= (0.3)^{\frac{1}{3}} \times (0.3 \times 3)^{\frac{2}{3}} \times 3^{\frac{16}{12}}$$

$$= (0.3)^{\frac{1}{3}} \times (0.3)^{\frac{2}{3}} \times (3)^{\frac{2}{3}} \times (3)^{\frac{4}{3}}$$

$$= (0.3)^{\frac{1}{3} + \frac{2}{3}} \times 3^{\frac{2}{3} + \frac{4}{3}} = (0.3)^{\frac{1+2}{3}} \times 3^{\frac{2+4}{3}} = 0.3 \times 3^2$$

$$= 0.3 \times 9 = 2.7$$

$$17. (a); \text{Expression} = \frac{2^n \times 2^4 - 2 \times 2^n}{2 \times 2^n \times 2^3} + \frac{1}{2^3}$$

$$= \frac{2^n (2^4 - 2)}{2^n (2 \times 2^3)} + \frac{1}{2^3} = \frac{16-2}{16} + \frac{1}{8} = \frac{7}{8} + \frac{1}{8} = 1$$

$$18. (b); 10^{0.48} = x, 10^{0.7} = y \text{ and } x^z = y^2$$

$$\therefore (10^{0.48})^z = (10^{0.7})^2$$

$$\Rightarrow 10^{0.48z} = 10^{1.4} \Rightarrow 0.48z = 1.4$$

$$\Rightarrow z = \frac{1.4}{0.48} = \frac{140}{48} = \frac{35}{12} = 2\frac{11}{12}$$

$$19. (a); \text{Expression} = (27)^{-\frac{2}{3}} + \left[\left(2^{\frac{-2}{3}} \right)^{\frac{5}{3}} \right]^{\frac{9}{10}}$$

$$= (3^3)^{-\frac{2}{3}} + \left(2^{\frac{-2}{3} \times \frac{5}{3}} \right)^{\frac{9}{10}} = 3^{3 \times \frac{-2}{3}} + 2^{\frac{-2 \times 5 \times 9}{3 \times 3 \times 10}}$$

$$= 3^{-2} + 2^{-1} = \frac{1}{3^2} + \frac{1}{2} = \frac{1}{9} + \frac{1}{2} = \frac{2+9}{18} = \frac{11}{18}$$

$$20. \text{ (b); First term} = \sqrt{8+3\sqrt{7}} = \sqrt{\frac{(8+3\sqrt{7}) \times 2}{2}}$$

$$= \sqrt{\frac{16+6\sqrt{7}}{2}} = \sqrt{\frac{3^2 + (\sqrt{7})^2 + 2 \times 3 \times \sqrt{7}}{2}}$$

$$= \sqrt{\frac{(3+\sqrt{7})^2}{2}} = \frac{3+\sqrt{7}}{\sqrt{2}}$$

$$\text{Second term} = \sqrt{7+3\sqrt{5}} = \sqrt{\frac{(7+3\sqrt{5}) \times 2}{2}}$$

$$= \sqrt{\frac{14+6\sqrt{5}}{2}} = \sqrt{\frac{3^2 + (\sqrt{5})^2 + 2 \times 3 \times \sqrt{5}}{2}}$$

$$= \sqrt{\frac{(3+\sqrt{5})^2}{2}} = \frac{3+\sqrt{5}}{\sqrt{2}}$$

$$\therefore \text{ Expression} = \frac{3+\sqrt{7}}{\sqrt{2}} - \frac{3+\sqrt{5}}{\sqrt{2}}$$

$$= \frac{3+\sqrt{7}-3-\sqrt{5}}{\sqrt{2}} = \frac{\sqrt{7}-\sqrt{5}}{\sqrt{2}} = \frac{\sqrt{14}-\sqrt{10}}{2}$$

$$21. \text{ (b); First term} = \sqrt{38+5\sqrt{3}} = \sqrt{\frac{(38+5\sqrt{3}) \times 2}{2}}$$

$$= \sqrt{\frac{76+10\sqrt{3}}{2}} = \sqrt{\frac{75+1+2 \times 5\sqrt{3} \times 1}{2}}$$

$$= \sqrt{\frac{(5\sqrt{3}+1)^2}{2}} = \frac{5\sqrt{3}+1}{\sqrt{2}}$$

$$\text{Second term} = \sqrt{3-\sqrt{5}} = \sqrt{\frac{(3-\sqrt{5}) \times 2}{2}}$$

$$= \sqrt{\frac{6-2\sqrt{5}}{2}} = \sqrt{\frac{(\sqrt{5})^2 + 1 - 2\sqrt{5}}{2}}$$

$$= \sqrt{\frac{(\sqrt{5}-1)^2}{2}} = \frac{\sqrt{5}-1}{\sqrt{2}}$$

$$\therefore \text{ Expression} = \frac{5\sqrt{3}+1}{\sqrt{2}} + \frac{\sqrt{5}-1}{\sqrt{2}}$$

$$= \frac{5\sqrt{3}+1+\sqrt{5}-1}{\sqrt{2}} = \frac{5\sqrt{3}+\sqrt{5}}{\sqrt{2}}$$

$$= \frac{5\sqrt{3}+\sqrt{5}}{\sqrt{2}} \times \frac{\sqrt{2}}{\sqrt{2}} = \frac{5\sqrt{6}+\sqrt{10}}{2}$$

$$22. \text{ (a); First term} = \sqrt{4-\sqrt{7}} = \sqrt{\frac{(4-\sqrt{7}) \times 2}{2}}$$

$$= \sqrt{\frac{8-2\sqrt{7}}{2}} = \sqrt{\frac{(\sqrt{7})^2 + 1 - 2\sqrt{7}}{2}}$$

$$= \sqrt{\frac{(\sqrt{7}-1)^2}{2}} = \frac{\sqrt{7}-1}{\sqrt{2}}$$

$$\text{Second term} = \sqrt{8+3\sqrt{7}} = \sqrt{\frac{(8+3\sqrt{7}) \times 2}{2}}$$

$$= \sqrt{\frac{16+6\sqrt{7}}{2}} = \sqrt{\frac{3^2 + (\sqrt{7})^2 + 2 \times 3 \times \sqrt{7}}{2}}$$

$$= \sqrt{\frac{(3+\sqrt{7})^2}{2}} = \frac{3+\sqrt{7}}{\sqrt{2}}$$

$$\therefore \text{ Expression} = \frac{\sqrt{7}-1}{\sqrt{2}} + \frac{3+\sqrt{7}}{\sqrt{2}} = \frac{2\sqrt{7}+2}{\sqrt{2}}$$

$$= \frac{2\sqrt{14}+2\sqrt{2}}{2} = \sqrt{14}+\sqrt{2} = \sqrt{2}(\sqrt{7}+1)$$

$$23. \text{ (b); Denominator of expression}$$

$$= \sqrt{10} + \sqrt{20} + \sqrt{40} - \sqrt{5} - \sqrt{80}$$

$$= \sqrt{10} + \sqrt{2^2 \times 5} + \sqrt{2^2 \times 10} - \sqrt{5} - \sqrt{2^4 \times 5}$$

$$= \sqrt{10} + 2\sqrt{5} + 2\sqrt{10} - \sqrt{5} - 4\sqrt{5}$$

$$= (1+2)\sqrt{10} + (2-1-4)\sqrt{5}$$

$$= 3\sqrt{10} - 3\sqrt{5} = 3(\sqrt{10} - \sqrt{5})$$

$$\therefore \text{ Expression} = \frac{15}{\sqrt{10} + \sqrt{20} + \sqrt{40} - \sqrt{5} - \sqrt{80}}$$

$$= \frac{15}{3(\sqrt{10} - \sqrt{5})} = \frac{5}{\sqrt{10} - \sqrt{5}} \times \frac{\sqrt{10} + \sqrt{5}}{\sqrt{10} + \sqrt{5}}$$

$$= \frac{5(\sqrt{10} + \sqrt{5})}{10 - 5} = \sqrt{10} + \sqrt{5}$$

$$= 3.162 + 2.236 = 5.398$$

$$24. \text{ (b); Expression} = \frac{\left(2^{2n} - 3 \cdot \frac{2^{2n}}{2^2}\right) \left(3^n - \frac{2 \cdot 3^n}{3^2}\right)}{\frac{3^n}{3^4} (4^n \cdot 4^3 - 2^{2n})}$$

$$= \frac{3^n \cdot 2^{2n} \left(1 - \frac{3}{2^2}\right) \left(1 - \frac{2}{3^2}\right)}{3^n \cdot 2^{2n} \left(\frac{2^6 - 1}{3^4}\right)}$$

$$= \frac{\left(1 - \frac{3}{4}\right)\left(1 - \frac{2}{9}\right)}{\frac{64-1}{81}} = \frac{\frac{1}{4} \times \frac{7}{9}}{\frac{63}{81}} = \frac{7}{36} \times \frac{81}{63} = \frac{1}{4}.$$

25. (b); Rationalising the denominator,

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\sqrt{2} + \sqrt{3}}{3\sqrt{2} - 2\sqrt{3}} &= \frac{\sqrt{2} + \sqrt{3}}{3\sqrt{2} - 2\sqrt{3}} \times \frac{3\sqrt{2} + 2\sqrt{3}}{3\sqrt{2} + 2\sqrt{3}} \\ &= \frac{\sqrt{2} \times 3\sqrt{2} + \sqrt{2} \times 2\sqrt{3} + \sqrt{3} \times 3\sqrt{2} + \sqrt{3} \times 2\sqrt{3}}{(3\sqrt{2})^2 - (2\sqrt{3})^2} \\ &= \frac{3\sqrt{2} \times 2 + 2\sqrt{2} \times 3 + 3\sqrt{2} \times 3 + 2\sqrt{3} \times 3}{9 \times 2 - 4 \times 3} \\ &= \frac{3 \times 2 + 2\sqrt{6} + 3\sqrt{6} + 2 \times 3}{18 - 12} \\ &= \frac{12 + 5\sqrt{6}}{6} = \frac{12}{6} + \frac{5\sqrt{6}}{6} = 2 + \frac{5\sqrt{6}}{6} \\ \therefore \frac{\sqrt{2} + \sqrt{3}}{3\sqrt{2} - 2\sqrt{3}} &= a - b\sqrt{6} \\ \Rightarrow 2 + \frac{5\sqrt{6}}{6} &= a - b\sqrt{6} \Rightarrow a = 2 \text{ and } b = \frac{-5}{6} \\ \therefore (a+b)^2 &= \left(2 - \frac{5}{6}\right)^2 = \left(\frac{12-5}{6}\right)^2 = \left(\frac{7}{6}\right)^2 = \frac{49}{36} \end{aligned}$$

26. (a); Rationalising the denominator,

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{7\sqrt{3}}{\sqrt{10} + \sqrt{3}} - \frac{2\sqrt{5}}{\sqrt{6} + \sqrt{5}} - \frac{3\sqrt{2}}{\sqrt{15} + 3\sqrt{2}} \\ = \frac{7\sqrt{3}}{\sqrt{10} + \sqrt{3}} \times \frac{\sqrt{10} - \sqrt{3}}{\sqrt{10} - \sqrt{3}} - \frac{2\sqrt{5}}{\sqrt{6} + \sqrt{5}} \times \frac{\sqrt{6} - \sqrt{5}}{\sqrt{6} - \sqrt{5}} - \\ \frac{3\sqrt{2}}{\sqrt{15} + 3\sqrt{2}} \times \frac{\sqrt{15} - 3\sqrt{2}}{\sqrt{15} - 3\sqrt{2}} \\ = \frac{7\sqrt{3}(\sqrt{10} - \sqrt{3})}{(\sqrt{10})^2 - (\sqrt{3})^2} - \frac{2\sqrt{5}(\sqrt{6} - \sqrt{5})}{(\sqrt{6})^2 - (\sqrt{5})^2} - \\ \frac{3\sqrt{2}(\sqrt{15} - 3\sqrt{2})}{(\sqrt{15})^2 - (3\sqrt{2})^2} \\ = \frac{7\sqrt{3}(\sqrt{10} - \sqrt{3})}{10 - 3} - \frac{2\sqrt{5}(\sqrt{6} - \sqrt{5})}{6 - 5} - \\ \frac{3\sqrt{2}(\sqrt{15} - 3\sqrt{2})}{15 - 9 \times 2} \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} &= \sqrt{3}(\sqrt{10} - \sqrt{3}) - 2\sqrt{5}(\sqrt{6} - \sqrt{5}) + \sqrt{2}(\sqrt{15} - 3\sqrt{2}) \\ &= \sqrt{30} - 3 - 2\sqrt{30} + 2 \times 5 + \sqrt{30} - 3 \times 2 \\ &= -3 + 10 - 6 + \sqrt{30} - 2\sqrt{30} + \sqrt{30} \\ &= 1 + (1 - 2 + 1)\sqrt{30} = 1 \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} 27. (b); \frac{\sqrt{5} - 2}{\sqrt{5} + 2} - \frac{\sqrt{5} + 2}{\sqrt{5} - 2} &= \frac{(\sqrt{5} - 2)^2 - (\sqrt{5} + 2)^2}{(\sqrt{5} + 2)(\sqrt{5} - 2)} \\ &= \frac{[(\sqrt{5})^2 + 2^2 - 2 \times \sqrt{5} \times 2] - [(\sqrt{5})^2 + 2^2 + 2 \times \sqrt{5} \times 2]}{(\sqrt{5})^2 - (2)^2} \\ &= \frac{(5 + 4 - 4\sqrt{5}) - (5 + 4 + 4\sqrt{5})}{5 - 4} \\ &= 9 - 4\sqrt{5} - 9 - 4\sqrt{5} = -8\sqrt{5} \end{aligned}$$

28. (c); Rationalising the denominator,

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{1}{3 - \sqrt{8}} \times \frac{3 + \sqrt{8}}{3 + \sqrt{8}} - \frac{1}{\sqrt{8} - \sqrt{7}} \times \frac{\sqrt{8} + \sqrt{7}}{\sqrt{8} + \sqrt{7}} + \frac{1}{\sqrt{7} - \sqrt{6}} \\ \times \frac{\sqrt{7} + \sqrt{6}}{\sqrt{7} + \sqrt{6}} - \frac{1}{\sqrt{6} - \sqrt{5}} \times \frac{\sqrt{6} + \sqrt{5}}{\sqrt{6} + \sqrt{5}} + \frac{1}{\sqrt{5} - 2} \times \frac{\sqrt{5} + 2}{\sqrt{5} + 2} \\ = \frac{3 + \sqrt{8}}{3^2 - (\sqrt{8})^2} - \frac{\sqrt{8} + \sqrt{7}}{(\sqrt{8})^2 - (\sqrt{7})^2} + \frac{\sqrt{7} + \sqrt{6}}{(\sqrt{7})^2 - (\sqrt{6})^2} \\ - \frac{\sqrt{6} + \sqrt{5}}{(\sqrt{6})^2 - (\sqrt{5})^2} + \frac{\sqrt{5} + 2}{(\sqrt{5})^2 - (2)^2} \\ = \frac{3 + \sqrt{8}}{9 - 8} - \frac{\sqrt{8} + \sqrt{7}}{8 - 7} + \frac{\sqrt{7} + \sqrt{6}}{7 - 6} - \frac{\sqrt{6} + \sqrt{5}}{6 - 5} + \frac{\sqrt{5} + 2}{5 - 4} \\ = (3 + \sqrt{8}) - (\sqrt{8} + \sqrt{7}) + (\sqrt{7} + \sqrt{6}) - (\sqrt{6} + \sqrt{5}) \\ + (\sqrt{5} + 2) \\ = 3 + \sqrt{8} - \sqrt{8} - \sqrt{7} + \sqrt{7} + \sqrt{6} - \sqrt{6} - \sqrt{5} + \sqrt{5} + 2 \\ = 3 + 2 = 5 \end{aligned}$$

$$29. (d); \text{Expression} = (9)^{-3} \times \frac{(16)^{\frac{1}{4}}}{(6)^{-2}} \times \left(\frac{1}{27}\right)^{-\frac{4}{3}}$$

$$\begin{aligned} &= (3^2)^{-3} \times \frac{(2^4)^{\frac{1}{4}}}{(2 \times 3)^{-2}} \times \left(\frac{1}{3^3}\right)^{-\frac{4}{3}} \\ &= 3^{-6} \times \frac{2}{2^{-2} \times 3^{-2}} \times (3^3)^{\frac{4}{3}} \quad \left[\because \left(\frac{a}{b}\right)^{-n} = \left(\frac{b}{a}\right)^n \right] \\ &= 3^{-6} \times 2 \times 3^4 \times 2^2 \times 3^2 \quad \left[\because a^n = \frac{1}{a^{-n}} \right] \end{aligned}$$

$$= 3^0 \times 2^3 = 1 \times 8 = 8$$

$\therefore$ Required answer = 7

$$\Rightarrow \frac{x+\sqrt{3}}{x-\sqrt{3}} = \frac{2\sqrt{2}+\sqrt{3}+\sqrt{2}}{2\sqrt{2}-\sqrt{3}-\sqrt{2}} = \frac{\sqrt{3}+3\sqrt{2}}{\sqrt{2}-\sqrt{3}}$$

∴ Expression

$$\begin{aligned}
 &= \frac{x+\sqrt{2}}{x-\sqrt{2}} + \frac{x+\sqrt{3}}{x-\sqrt{3}} = \frac{3\sqrt{3}+\sqrt{2}}{\sqrt{3}-\sqrt{2}} + \frac{\sqrt{3}+3\sqrt{2}}{\sqrt{2}-\sqrt{3}} \\
 &= \frac{3\sqrt{3}+\sqrt{2}}{\sqrt{3}-\sqrt{2}} - \frac{\sqrt{3}+3\sqrt{2}}{\sqrt{3}-\sqrt{2}} = \frac{3\sqrt{3}+\sqrt{2}-\sqrt{3}-3\sqrt{2}}{\sqrt{3}-\sqrt{2}} \\
 &= \frac{2(\sqrt{3}-\sqrt{2})}{\sqrt{3}-\sqrt{2}} = 2
 \end{aligned}$$

4. (c); $x = \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}$

$$\begin{aligned}
 \therefore \sqrt{1+x} &= \sqrt{1+\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}} \\
 &= \sqrt{\frac{2+\sqrt{3}}{2}} = \sqrt{\frac{4+2\sqrt{3}}{4}} = \sqrt{\frac{(\sqrt{3}+1)^2}{4}} = \frac{\sqrt{3}+1}{2} \\
 \therefore \sqrt{1-x} &= \frac{\sqrt{3}-1}{2} \\
 \therefore \sqrt{1+x} + \sqrt{1-x} &= \frac{\sqrt{3}+1}{2} + \frac{\sqrt{3}-1}{2} = \frac{\sqrt{3}+1+\sqrt{3}-1}{2} = \sqrt{3}
 \end{aligned}$$

5. (a); First part = $\sqrt{11-2\sqrt{30}} = \sqrt{11-2\sqrt{6 \times 5}}$

$$\begin{aligned}
 &= \sqrt{11-2 \times \sqrt{6} \times \sqrt{5}} = \sqrt{6+5-2 \times \sqrt{6} \times \sqrt{5}} \\
 &= \sqrt{(\sqrt{6})^2 + (\sqrt{5})^2 - 2 \times \sqrt{6} \times \sqrt{5}} \\
 &= \sqrt{(\sqrt{6}-\sqrt{5})^2} = \sqrt{6}-\sqrt{5}
 \end{aligned}$$

Second part = $\sqrt{7-2\sqrt{10}}$

$$\begin{aligned}
 &= \sqrt{7-2\sqrt{5 \times 2}} = \sqrt{7-2\sqrt{5} \times \sqrt{2}} \\
 &= \sqrt{5+2-2\sqrt{5} \times \sqrt{2}} \\
 &= \sqrt{(\sqrt{5})^2 + (\sqrt{2})^2 - 2 \times \sqrt{5} \times \sqrt{2}} \\
 &= \sqrt{(\sqrt{5}-\sqrt{2})^2} = \sqrt{5}-\sqrt{2}
 \end{aligned}$$

Third part = $\frac{4}{\sqrt{6}+\sqrt{2}}$

Rationalising the denominator,

$$= \frac{4}{(\sqrt{6}+\sqrt{2})} \times \frac{(\sqrt{6}-\sqrt{2})}{(\sqrt{6}-\sqrt{2})}$$

$$= \frac{4(\sqrt{6}-\sqrt{2})}{(\sqrt{6})^2 - (\sqrt{2})^2} = \frac{4(\sqrt{6}-\sqrt{2})}{6-2} = \sqrt{6}-\sqrt{2}$$

∴ Expression

$$\begin{aligned}
 &= (\sqrt{6}-\sqrt{5}) + (\sqrt{5}-\sqrt{2}) - (\sqrt{6}-\sqrt{2}) \\
 &= \sqrt{6}-\sqrt{5}+\sqrt{5}-\sqrt{2}-\sqrt{6}+\sqrt{2} = 0
 \end{aligned}$$

6. (c); First part = $\sqrt{\frac{(2.4)^6 + 9(5.76) + 6(2.4)^4}{(2.4)^4 + 6(5.76) + 9}}$

$$\begin{aligned}
 &= \sqrt{\frac{(2.4)^6 + 9(2.4)^2 + 6(2.4)^4}{(2.4)^4 + 6(2.4)^2 + 9}} \\
 &= \sqrt{\frac{(2.4)^2 [(2.4)^4 + 9 + 6(2.4)^2]}{(2.4)^4 + 6(2.4)^2 + 9}} = \sqrt{(2.4)^2} = 2.4
 \end{aligned}$$

Second part = $\frac{[(3^{-2})^{-5}]^{\frac{1}{5}} + [(4^{-3})^{-6}]^{\frac{1}{6}} - (3^{-4})^{-\frac{1}{2}}}{[(2^{-3})^{-4}]^{\frac{1}{4}}}$

$$= \frac{(3)^{(-2) \times (-5) \times (\frac{1}{5})} + (4)^{(-3) \times (-6) \times \frac{1}{6}} - (3)^{(-4) \times (-\frac{1}{2})}}{(2)^{(-3) \times (-4) \times (\frac{1}{4})}}$$

$$\left[\because [(a^x)^y]^z = a^{xyz} \right]$$

$$= \frac{3^2 + 4^3 - 3^2}{2^3} = \frac{9 + 64 - 9}{8} = \frac{64}{8} = 8$$

∴ Expression = $2.4 + 8 = 10.4$

7. (d); $\left(\frac{x^a}{x^{-b}}\right)^{a^2+b^2-ab} \times \left(\frac{x^b}{x^{-c}}\right)^{b^2+c^2-bc} \times \left(\frac{x^c}{x^{-a}}\right)^{c^2+a^2-ca}$

$$\begin{aligned}
 &= (x^{a+b})^{a^2+b^2-ab} \times (x^{b+c})^{b^2+c^2-bc} \times (x^{c+a})^{c^2+a^2-ca} \\
 &= x^{(a+b)(a^2+b^2-ab)} \times x^{(b+c)(b^2+c^2-bc)} \times x^{(c+a)(c^2+a^2-ca)} \\
 &= x^{a^3+b^3} \times x^{b^3+c^3} \times x^{c^3+a^3} \\
 &= x^{a^3+b^3+b^3+c^3+c^3+a^3} = x^{2(a^3+b^3+c^3)}
 \end{aligned}$$

8. (b); It is given $2^x = 4^y = 8^z = k$ (Let)

$$\Rightarrow 2 = k^{\frac{1}{x}}, 4 = k^{\frac{1}{y}}, 8 = k^{\frac{1}{z}}$$

Now, $4 \times 8 = 32 = 2^5$

$$\Rightarrow k^{\frac{1}{y}} \times k^{\frac{1}{z}} = \left(k^{\frac{1}{x}}\right)^5 \Rightarrow k^{\frac{1}{y} + \frac{1}{z}} = k^{\frac{5}{x}}$$

$$\Rightarrow \frac{1}{y} + \frac{1}{z} = \frac{5}{x}$$

$$\text{Now, } \frac{1}{2x} + \frac{1}{4y} + \frac{1}{4z} = 4$$

$$\Rightarrow \frac{1}{2x} + \frac{1}{4} \left(\frac{1}{y} + \frac{1}{z} \right) = 4 \Rightarrow \frac{1}{2x} + \frac{1}{4} \left(\frac{5}{x} \right) = 4$$

$$\Rightarrow \frac{1}{2x} + \frac{5}{4x} = 4 \Rightarrow \frac{2+5}{4x} = 4$$

$$\Rightarrow \frac{7}{4x} = 4 \Rightarrow 16x = 7 \Rightarrow x = \frac{7}{16}$$

9. (c); Let $x = \frac{\sqrt{\sqrt{5}+2} + \sqrt{\sqrt{5}-2}}{\sqrt{\sqrt{5}+1}}$

On squaring both sides.

$$\Rightarrow x^2 = \left[\frac{\sqrt{\sqrt{5}+2} + \sqrt{\sqrt{5}-2}}{\sqrt{\sqrt{5}+1}} \right]^2$$

$$= \frac{[\sqrt{\sqrt{5}+2} + \sqrt{\sqrt{5}-2}]^2}{[\sqrt{\sqrt{5}+1}]^2}$$

$$= \frac{\sqrt{5}+2 + \sqrt{5}-2 + 2\sqrt{\sqrt{5}+2} \cdot \sqrt{\sqrt{5}-2}}{\sqrt{5}+1}$$

$$= \frac{2\sqrt{5} + 2\sqrt{(\sqrt{5})^2 - (2)^2}}{\sqrt{5}+1}$$

$$= \frac{2\sqrt{5}+2}{\sqrt{5}+1} = \frac{2(\sqrt{5}+1)}{\sqrt{5}+1} = 2 \quad \therefore x = \sqrt{2}$$

Again, $\sqrt{3-2\sqrt{2}} = \sqrt{2+1-2 \times \sqrt{2} \times 1}$

$$= \sqrt{(\sqrt{2})^2 + (1)^2 - 2 \times \sqrt{2} \times 1}$$

$$= \sqrt{(\sqrt{2}-1)^2} = \sqrt{2}-1$$

$$\therefore \frac{\sqrt{\sqrt{5}+2} + \sqrt{\sqrt{5}-2}}{\sqrt{\sqrt{5}+1}} - \sqrt{3-2\sqrt{2}}$$

$$= \sqrt{2} - (\sqrt{2}-1) = 1$$

10. (d); First term = $\sqrt{11+4\sqrt{7}}$

$$= \sqrt{2^2 + (\sqrt{7})^2 + 2 \times 2 \times \sqrt{7}} = \sqrt{(2+\sqrt{7})^2} = 2+\sqrt{7}$$

Second term

$$= \sqrt{11-4\sqrt{7}} = \sqrt{(2)^2 + (\sqrt{7})^2 - 2 \times 2 \times \sqrt{7}}$$

$$= \sqrt{(\sqrt{7}-2)^2} = \sqrt{7}-2$$

$$\text{Third term} = \frac{\sqrt{8}}{\sqrt{33+10\sqrt{8}} - \sqrt{33-10\sqrt{8}}}$$

$$= \frac{\sqrt{8}}{\sqrt{(5)^2 + (\sqrt{8})^2 + 2 \times 5 \times \sqrt{8}} - \sqrt{(5)^2 + (\sqrt{8})^2 - 2 \times 5 \times \sqrt{8}}}$$

$$= \frac{\sqrt{8}}{\sqrt{(5+\sqrt{8})^2} - \sqrt{(5-\sqrt{8})^2}}$$

$$= \frac{\sqrt{8}}{5+\sqrt{8}-5+\sqrt{8}} = \frac{\sqrt{8}}{2\sqrt{8}} = \frac{1}{2}$$

$$\therefore \text{Expression} = 2 + \sqrt{7} - \sqrt{7} + 2 + \frac{1}{2} = 4\frac{1}{2}$$

11. (b); Expression

$$= \frac{26-15\sqrt{3}}{[5\sqrt{2}-\sqrt{38+5\sqrt{3}}]^2} + \frac{\sqrt{10}+\sqrt{18}}{\sqrt{8}+\sqrt{(3-\sqrt{5})}}$$

Now, $\sqrt{38+5\sqrt{3}} = \sqrt{(38+5\sqrt{3}) \times \frac{2}{2}}$

$$= \sqrt{\frac{76+2(5\sqrt{3})}{2}} = \sqrt{\frac{75+1+2(5\sqrt{3})}{2}}$$

$$= \sqrt{\frac{(5\sqrt{3})^2 + (1)^2 + 2(5\sqrt{3}) \times 1}{2}}$$

$$= \sqrt{\frac{(5\sqrt{3}+1)^2}{2}} = \frac{5\sqrt{3}+1}{\sqrt{2}}$$

$$\therefore (5\sqrt{2}-\sqrt{38+5\sqrt{3}})^2 = \left(5\sqrt{2} - \frac{5\sqrt{3}+1}{\sqrt{2}} \right)^2$$

$$= \left(\frac{10-5\sqrt{3}-1}{\sqrt{2}} \right)^2 = \frac{(9-5\sqrt{3})^2}{2}$$

and $\sqrt{(3-\sqrt{5})} = \sqrt{(3-\sqrt{5}) \times \frac{2}{2}}$

$$= \sqrt{\frac{6-2\sqrt{5}}{2}} = \sqrt{\frac{5+1-2(\sqrt{5}) \times 1}{2}}$$

$$= \sqrt{\frac{(\sqrt{5})^2 + (1)^2 - 2\sqrt{5}}{2}} = \sqrt{\frac{(\sqrt{5}-1)^2}{2}} = \frac{\sqrt{5}-1}{\sqrt{2}}$$

$$\begin{aligned}
& \therefore \frac{26-15\sqrt{3}}{\left(5\sqrt{2}-\frac{5\sqrt{3}+1}{\sqrt{2}}\right)^2} + \frac{\sqrt{2}(\sqrt{5}+3)}{\sqrt{8}+\frac{\sqrt{5}-1}{\sqrt{2}}} \\
& = \frac{2(26-15\sqrt{3})}{(9-5\sqrt{3})^2} + \frac{\sqrt{2}\sqrt{2}(\sqrt{5}+3)}{4+\sqrt{5}-1} \\
& = \frac{52-30\sqrt{3}}{156-90\sqrt{3}} + \frac{2(3+\sqrt{5})}{(3+\sqrt{5})} \\
& = \frac{52-30\sqrt{3}}{3(52-30\sqrt{3})} + 2 = \frac{1}{3} + 2 = 2\frac{1}{3}
\end{aligned}$$

12. (c); First term = $(28-10\sqrt{3})^{\frac{1}{2}}$

$$\begin{aligned}
& = (25+3-10\sqrt{3})^{\frac{1}{2}} = [(5)^2 + (\sqrt{3})^2 - 2 \times 5 \times \sqrt{3}]^{\frac{1}{2}} \\
& = [(5-\sqrt{3})^2]^{\frac{1}{2}} = (5-\sqrt{3})^{2 \times \frac{1}{2}} = (5-\sqrt{3})
\end{aligned}$$

Second term = $(7+4\sqrt{3})^{\frac{1}{2}} = (4+3+4\sqrt{3})^{\frac{1}{2}}$

$$\begin{aligned}
& = [(2)^2 + (\sqrt{3})^2 + 2 \times 2 \times \sqrt{3}]^{\frac{1}{2}} \\
& = [(2+\sqrt{3})^2]^{\frac{1}{2}} = (2+\sqrt{3})^{2 \times \frac{1}{2}} \\
& = (2+\sqrt{3})^{-1} = \frac{1}{(2+\sqrt{3})} \\
& = \frac{1}{2+\sqrt{3}} \times \frac{2-\sqrt{3}}{2-\sqrt{3}} = \frac{2-\sqrt{3}}{4-3} = 2-\sqrt{3}
\end{aligned}$$

Third term = $\frac{\sqrt{7}}{\sqrt{16+6\sqrt{7}}-\sqrt{16-6\sqrt{7}}}$

$$= \frac{\sqrt{7}}{\sqrt{9+7+2 \times 3 \times \sqrt{7}}-\sqrt{9+7-2 \times 3 \times \sqrt{7}}}$$

$$= \frac{\sqrt{7}}{\sqrt{(3+\sqrt{7})^2}-\sqrt{(3-\sqrt{7})^2}}$$

$$= \frac{\sqrt{7}}{(3+\sqrt{7})-(3-\sqrt{7})} = \frac{\sqrt{7}}{3+\sqrt{7}-3+\sqrt{7}}$$

(Taking square root)

$$= \frac{\sqrt{7}}{2\sqrt{7}} = \frac{1}{2}$$

$$\begin{aligned}
\therefore \text{Expression} & = (28-10\sqrt{3})^{\frac{1}{2}} - (7+4\sqrt{3})^{\frac{1}{2}} \\
& \quad + \frac{\sqrt{7}}{\sqrt{16+6\sqrt{7}}-\sqrt{16-6\sqrt{7}}} \\
& = 5-\sqrt{3}-(2+\sqrt{3})+\frac{1}{2}
\end{aligned}$$

$$= 5-\sqrt{3}-2+\sqrt{3}+\frac{1}{2} = 3+\frac{1}{2} = 3\frac{1}{2}$$

13. (d); $\frac{4\sqrt{3}}{2-\sqrt{2}} - \frac{30}{4\sqrt{3}-\sqrt{18}} - \frac{\sqrt{18}}{3-2\sqrt{3}}$

Rationalising the denominators by corresponding conjugates

$$\begin{aligned}
& = \frac{4\sqrt{3}(2+\sqrt{2})}{(2-\sqrt{2})(2+\sqrt{2})} \\
& \quad - \frac{30(4\sqrt{3}+\sqrt{18})}{(4\sqrt{3}-\sqrt{18})(4\sqrt{3}+\sqrt{18})} - \frac{\sqrt{18}(3+2\sqrt{3})}{(3-2\sqrt{3})(3+2\sqrt{3})}
\end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned}
& = \frac{4\sqrt{3}(2+\sqrt{2})}{(2)^2-(\sqrt{2})^2} - \frac{30(4\sqrt{3}+\sqrt{18})}{(4\sqrt{3})^2-(\sqrt{18})^2} - \frac{\sqrt{18}(3+2\sqrt{3})}{(3)^2-(2\sqrt{3})^2} \\
& \quad [(a-b)(a+b) = a^2 - b^2]
\end{aligned}$$

$$= \frac{4\sqrt{3}(2+\sqrt{2})}{4-2} - \frac{30(4\sqrt{3}+\sqrt{18})}{48-18} - \frac{\sqrt{18}(3+2\sqrt{3})}{9-12}$$

$$= \frac{4\sqrt{3}(2+\sqrt{2})}{2} - \frac{30(4\sqrt{3}+\sqrt{18})}{30} - \frac{3\sqrt{2}(3+2\sqrt{3})}{-3}$$

$$= 2\sqrt{3}(2+\sqrt{2}) - (4\sqrt{3}+\sqrt{18}) + \sqrt{2}(3+2\sqrt{3})$$

$$= 4\sqrt{3}+2\sqrt{6}-4\sqrt{3}-3\sqrt{2}+3\sqrt{2}+2\sqrt{6}$$

$$= 2\sqrt{6}+2\sqrt{6} = 4\sqrt{6}$$

14. (c); First term = $\sqrt{\frac{(12.12)^2 - (8.12)^2}{(0.25)^2 + (0.25)(19.99)}}$

$$= \sqrt{\frac{(12.12+8.12)(12.12-8.12)}{0.25(0.25+19.99)}}$$

$$[\because (a^2 - b^2) = (a+b)(a-b)]$$

$$= \sqrt{\frac{20.24 \times 4}{0.25 \times 20.24}} = \sqrt{\frac{4}{0.25}} = \sqrt{\frac{4 \times 100}{25}}$$

$$= \sqrt{\frac{400}{25}} = \sqrt{16} = 4$$

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Second term} &= \frac{\left[\left(8^{\frac{-3}{4}} \right)^{\frac{5}{2}} \right]^{\frac{8}{15}} \times 16^{\frac{3}{4}}}{\sqrt[3]{\left[\{(128)^{-5}\}^{\frac{3}{7}} \right]^{\frac{1}{5}}}} \\ &= \frac{\left[\left\{ (2^3)^{\frac{-3}{4}} \right\}^{\frac{5}{2}} \right]^{\frac{8}{15}} \times (2^4)^{\frac{3}{4}}}{\sqrt[3]{\left[\{(2^7)^{-5}\}^{\frac{3}{7}} \right]^{\frac{1}{5}}}} \left[\because 8 = 2^3, 16 = 2^4, 128 = 2^7 \right] \\ &= \frac{2^{3 \times \frac{-3}{4} \times \frac{5}{2} \times \frac{8}{15}} \times 2^{4 \times \frac{3}{4}}}{2^{7 \times (-5) \times \frac{3}{7} \times \left(\frac{1}{5} \right) \times \frac{1}{3}}} \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} &\left[\because \left[\{(a^m)^n\}^p \right]^q = a^{mnpq} \text{ and } \sqrt[3]{x} = (x)^{\frac{1}{3}} \right] \\ &= \frac{2^{-3} \times 2^3}{2} = \frac{2^{-3+3}}{2} = \frac{2^0}{2} = \frac{1}{2} \end{aligned}$$

$\therefore$ Expression = First term + second term

$$= 4 + \frac{1}{2} = 4\frac{1}{2}$$

$$15. \text{ (d); First term} = \frac{\sqrt[6]{2} \left[(625)^{\frac{3}{5}} \times (1024)^{-\frac{6}{5}} \div (25)^{\frac{3}{5}} \right]^{\frac{1}{2}}}{(\sqrt[3]{128})^{-\frac{5}{2}} \times (125)^{\frac{1}{5}}}$$

$$= \frac{2^{\frac{1}{6}} \left[(5^4)^{\frac{3}{5}} \times (2^{10})^{-\frac{6}{5}} \div (5^2)^{\frac{3}{5}} \right]^{\frac{1}{2}}}{\left\{ (128)^{\frac{1}{3}} \right\}^{\frac{5}{2}} \times (5^3)^{\frac{1}{5}}}$$

$$= \frac{2^{\frac{1}{6}} \left[5^{4 \times \frac{3}{5}} \times 2^{10 \times \frac{-6}{5}} \div 5^{2 \times \frac{3}{5}} \right]^{\frac{1}{2}}}{\left\{ (2^7)^{\frac{1}{3}} \right\}^{\frac{5}{2}} \times 5^{\frac{3 \times 1}{5}}}$$

$$= \frac{2^{\frac{1}{6}} \left[5^{\frac{12}{5}} \times 2^{-12} \div 5^{\frac{6}{5}} \right]^{\frac{1}{2}}}{2^{\left(7 \times \frac{1}{3} \times \frac{-5}{2} \right)} \times 5^{\frac{3}{5}}} = \frac{2^{\frac{1}{6}} \left[5^{\frac{6}{5}} \times 2^{-12} \right]^{\frac{1}{2}}}{2^{\frac{-35}{6}} \times 5^{\frac{3}{5}}}$$

$$= \frac{2^{\frac{1}{6}} \times 5^{\frac{3}{5}} \times 2^{-6}}{2^{\frac{-35}{6}} \times 5^{\frac{3}{5}}} = 2^{\left(\frac{1}{6} - 6 + \frac{35}{6} \right)} \times 5^{\frac{3}{5} - \frac{3}{5}}$$

$$= 2^{\left(\frac{1-36+35}{6} \right)} \times 5^0 = 2^{\frac{36-36}{6}} \times 5^0$$

$$= 2^0 \times 5^0 = 1 \times 1 = 1$$

$$\text{Second term} = \frac{(10^3)^2 \div (10^{3^2})}{(10^2)^3 \div 10^{2^3}} = \frac{10^{2 \times 3} \div 10^9}{10^{2 \times 3} \div 10^8}$$

$$= \frac{10^6 \div 10^9}{10^6 \div 10^8} = \frac{10^{(6-9)}}{10^{(6-8)}}$$

$$= \frac{10^{-3}}{10^{-2}} = 10^{(-3+2)} = 10^{-1} = \frac{1}{10}$$

$\therefore$ Expression

$$= \frac{\sqrt[6]{2} \left[(625)^{\frac{3}{5}} \times (1024)^{-\frac{6}{5}} \div (25)^{\frac{3}{5}} \right]^{\frac{1}{2}}}{(\sqrt[3]{128})^{-\frac{5}{2}} \times (125)^{\frac{1}{5}}} + \frac{(10^3)^2 \div (10^{3^2})}{(10^2)^3 \div 10^{2^3}}$$

$$= 1 + \frac{1}{10} = \frac{10+1}{10} = 1.1$$

$$16. \text{ (a); First term} = (18 - 8\sqrt{2})^{\frac{1}{2}}$$

$$= (16 + 2 - 8\sqrt{2})^{\frac{1}{2}} = \left\{ (4)^2 + (\sqrt{2})^2 - 2 \times 4 \times \sqrt{2} \right\}^{\frac{1}{2}}$$

$$= (4 - \sqrt{2})^{2 \times \frac{1}{2}} = 4 - \sqrt{2}$$

$$\text{Second term} = (6 - 4\sqrt{2})^{-\frac{1}{2}} = (4 + 2 - 4\sqrt{2})^{-\frac{1}{2}}$$

$$= \left\{ 2^2 + (\sqrt{2})^2 - 2 \times 2 \times \sqrt{2} \right\}^{-\frac{1}{2}}$$

$$= (2 - \sqrt{2})^{2 \times \frac{-1}{2}} = (2 - \sqrt{2})^{-1} = \frac{1}{2 - \sqrt{2}}$$

$$= \frac{1}{2 - \sqrt{2}} \times \frac{2 + \sqrt{2}}{2 + \sqrt{2}} = \frac{2 + \sqrt{2}}{2}$$

$$\text{Third term} = \frac{\sqrt{3}}{\sqrt{19 + 8\sqrt{3}} - \sqrt{19 - 8\sqrt{3}}}$$

$$= \frac{\sqrt{3}}{\sqrt{16 + 3 + 8\sqrt{3}} - \sqrt{16 + 3 - 8\sqrt{3}}}$$

$$= \frac{\sqrt{3}}{\sqrt{(4)^2 + (\sqrt{3})^2 + 2 \times 4 \times \sqrt{3}} - \sqrt{(4)^2 + (\sqrt{3})^2 - 2 \times 4 \times \sqrt{3}}}$$

$$= \frac{\sqrt{3}}{\sqrt{(4 + \sqrt{3})^2} - \sqrt{(4 - \sqrt{3})^2}}$$

$$= \frac{\sqrt{3}}{4 + \sqrt{3} - 4 + \sqrt{3}} = \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2\sqrt{3}} = \frac{1}{2}$$

$$\begin{aligned}\therefore \text{Expression} &= 4 - \sqrt{2} + \frac{2 + \sqrt{2}}{2} + \frac{1}{2} \\ &= \frac{8 - 2\sqrt{2} + 2 + \sqrt{2} + 1}{2} = \frac{11 - \sqrt{2}}{2}\end{aligned}$$

17. (d); First term = $\sqrt{7 + 4\sqrt{3}} = \sqrt{2^2 + (\sqrt{3})^2 + 2 \times 2 \times \sqrt{3}}$

$$= \sqrt{(2 + \sqrt{3})^2} = 2 + \sqrt{3}$$

Second term

$$= \sqrt{28 + 10\sqrt{3}} = \sqrt{(5)^2 + (\sqrt{3})^2 + 2 \times 5 \times \sqrt{3}}$$

$$= \sqrt{(5 + \sqrt{3})^2} = 5 + \sqrt{3}$$

$$\text{Third term} = \frac{\sqrt{11}}{\sqrt{20 + 6\sqrt{11}} + \sqrt{20 - 6\sqrt{11}}}$$

$$= \frac{\sqrt{11}}{\sqrt{3^2 + (\sqrt{11})^2 + 2 \times 3 \times \sqrt{11}} + \sqrt{3^2 + (\sqrt{11})^2 - 2 \times 3 \times \sqrt{11}}}$$

$$= \frac{\sqrt{11}}{\sqrt{(\sqrt{11} + 3)^2} + \sqrt{(\sqrt{11} - 3)^2}}$$

$$= \frac{\sqrt{11}}{\sqrt{11} + 3 + \sqrt{11} - 3} = \frac{\sqrt{11}}{2\sqrt{11}} = \frac{1}{2}$$

$$\text{Expression} = 2 + \sqrt{3} - 5 - \sqrt{3} + \frac{1}{2}$$

$$= -3 + \frac{1}{2} = \frac{-6 + 1}{2} = \frac{-5}{2} = -2\frac{1}{2}$$

18. (a); First term = $\frac{1}{\sqrt{11 - 2\sqrt{30}}}$

$$= \sqrt{\frac{1}{11 - 2\sqrt{30}}} = \sqrt{\frac{1 \times (11 + 2\sqrt{30})}{(11 - 2\sqrt{30})(11 + 2\sqrt{30})}}$$

(Rationalising the denominator)

$$= \sqrt{\frac{(11 + 2\sqrt{30})}{(11)^2 - (2\sqrt{30})^2}}$$

$$[\because (a + b)(a - b) = a^2 - b^2]$$

$$= \sqrt{\frac{11 + 2\sqrt{30}}{121 - 120}} = \sqrt{\frac{(11 + 2\sqrt{30})}{1}}$$

$$= \sqrt{(11 + 2\sqrt{30})} = \sqrt{5 + 6 + 2 \times \sqrt{5} \times \sqrt{6}}$$

$$= \sqrt{(\sqrt{5})^2 + (\sqrt{6})^2 + 2\sqrt{5} \times \sqrt{6}} = \sqrt{(\sqrt{5} + \sqrt{6})^2}$$

$$[a^2 + b^2 + 2ab = (a + b)^2]$$

$$= (\sqrt{5} + \sqrt{6})$$

$$\text{Second term} = \frac{3}{\sqrt{7 - 2\sqrt{10}}}$$

$$= \sqrt{\frac{9}{(7 - 2\sqrt{10})}} = \sqrt{\frac{9 \times (7 + 2\sqrt{10})}{(7 - 2\sqrt{10})(7 + 2\sqrt{10})}}$$

$$= \sqrt{\frac{9 \times (7 + 2\sqrt{10})}{49 - 40}} = \sqrt{\frac{9 \times (7 + 2\sqrt{10})}{9}}$$

$$= \sqrt{7 + 2\sqrt{10}} = \sqrt{5 + 2 + 2\sqrt{10}}$$

$$= \sqrt{(\sqrt{5})^2 + (\sqrt{2})^2 + 2\sqrt{5} \times \sqrt{2}}$$

$$= \sqrt{(\sqrt{5} + \sqrt{2})^2} = (\sqrt{5} + \sqrt{2})$$

$$\text{Similarly, third term} = \frac{4}{\sqrt{8 + 4\sqrt{3}}}$$

$$= \sqrt{\frac{16}{(8 + 4\sqrt{3})}} = \sqrt{\frac{16 \times (8 - 4\sqrt{3})}{(8 + 4\sqrt{3})(8 - 4\sqrt{3})}}$$

$$= \sqrt{\frac{16 \times (8 - 4\sqrt{3})}{64 - 48}} = \sqrt{\frac{16(8 - 4\sqrt{3})}{16}}$$

$$= \sqrt{(8 - 4\sqrt{3})} = \sqrt{(\sqrt{6})^2 + (\sqrt{2})^2 - 2 \times \sqrt{6} \times \sqrt{2}}$$

$$= \sqrt{(\sqrt{6} - \sqrt{2})^2} = (\sqrt{6} - \sqrt{2})$$

$\therefore$ Expression

$$= \frac{1}{\sqrt{11 - 2\sqrt{30}}} - \frac{3}{\sqrt{7 - 2\sqrt{10}}} - \frac{4}{\sqrt{8 + 4\sqrt{3}}}$$

$$= (\sqrt{5} + \sqrt{6}) - (\sqrt{5} + \sqrt{2}) - (\sqrt{6} - \sqrt{2})$$

$$= \sqrt{5} + \sqrt{6} - \sqrt{5} - \sqrt{2} - \sqrt{6} + \sqrt{2} = 0$$

19. (b); Expression = $\frac{\sqrt{1+x} + \sqrt{1-x}}{\sqrt{1+x} - \sqrt{1-x}}$

On rationalising the denominator,

$$= \frac{\sqrt{1+x} + \sqrt{1-x}}{\sqrt{1+x} - \sqrt{1-x}} \times \frac{\sqrt{1+x} + \sqrt{1-x}}{\sqrt{1+x} + \sqrt{1-x}}$$

$$= \frac{(\sqrt{1+x} + \sqrt{1-x})^2}{(\sqrt{1+x})^2 - (\sqrt{1-x})^2}$$

$$= \frac{1+x+1-x+2\sqrt{1+x}\cdot\sqrt{1-x}}{(1+x)-(1-x)} = \frac{1+\sqrt{1-x^2}}{x}$$

Putting $x = \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}$

$$\therefore \text{Expression} = \frac{1+\sqrt{1-\left(\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}\right)^2}}{\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}}$$

$$= \frac{1+\sqrt{1-\frac{3}{4}}}{\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}} = \frac{1+\sqrt{\frac{4-3}{4}}}{\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}}$$

$$= \frac{1+\frac{1}{2}}{\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}} = \frac{\frac{3}{2}}{\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}} = \frac{3}{2} \times \frac{2}{\sqrt{3}} = \sqrt{3}$$

20. (a); $x = \frac{\sqrt{a+2b} + \sqrt{a-2b}}{\sqrt{a+2b} - \sqrt{a-2b}}$

$$= \frac{\sqrt{a+2b} + \sqrt{a-2b}}{\sqrt{a+2b} - \sqrt{a-2b}} \times \frac{\sqrt{a+2b} + \sqrt{a-2b}}{\sqrt{a+2b} + \sqrt{a-2b}}$$

$$= \frac{(\sqrt{a+2b} + \sqrt{a-2b})^2}{(\sqrt{a+2b})^2 - (\sqrt{a-2b})^2}$$

$$= \frac{a+2b+a-2b+2\sqrt{a+2b}\times\sqrt{a-2b}}{(a+2b)-(a-2b)}$$

$$\therefore 2bx = a + \sqrt{a^2 - 4b^2}$$

$$\Rightarrow 2bx - a = \sqrt{a^2 - 4b^2}$$

$$\Rightarrow (2bx - a)^2 = (\sqrt{a^2 - 4b^2})^2$$

(Squaring both sides)

$$\Rightarrow 4b^2x^2 + a^2 - 4abx = a^2 - 4b^2$$

$$\Rightarrow 4b^2x^2 - 4abx + 4b^2 = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow 4b(bx^2 - ax + b) = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow bx^2 - ax + b = 0$$

(Dividing both sides by 4b)

Previous Year (Memory Based)

1. (c); $\left(\frac{3}{5}\right)^3 \left(\frac{3}{5}\right)^{-6} = \left(\frac{3}{5}\right)^{2x-1}$

$$\Rightarrow \left(\frac{3}{5}\right)^3 \left(\frac{3}{5}\right)^{-3} \left(\frac{3}{5}\right)^{-3} = \left(\frac{3}{5}\right)^{2x-1}$$

$$\Rightarrow \left(\frac{3}{5}\right)^0 \left(\frac{3}{5}\right)^{-3} = \left(\frac{3}{5}\right)^{2x-1}$$

$$\Rightarrow 2x - 1 = -3 \Rightarrow 2x = -3 + 1 \Rightarrow x = -1$$

2. (b); $\frac{\sqrt{7}-2}{\sqrt{7}+2} = \frac{\sqrt{7}-2}{\sqrt{7}+2} \times \frac{\sqrt{7}-2}{\sqrt{7}-2}$

(Rationalising the denominator)

$$= \frac{(\sqrt{7}-2)^2}{7-4} = \frac{7+4-4\sqrt{7}}{3} = \frac{11}{3} - \frac{4\sqrt{7}}{3}$$

$$\therefore \frac{\sqrt{7}-2}{\sqrt{7}+2} = a\sqrt{7} + b \Rightarrow \frac{11}{3} - \frac{4}{3}\sqrt{7} = a\sqrt{7} + b$$

Clearly, $a = -\frac{4}{3}$ and $b = \frac{11}{3}$

3. (a); $x = \frac{\sqrt{5}+\sqrt{3}}{\sqrt{5}-\sqrt{3}} = \frac{\sqrt{5}+\sqrt{3}}{\sqrt{5}-\sqrt{3}} \times \frac{\sqrt{5}+\sqrt{3}}{\sqrt{5}+\sqrt{3}}$

$$= \frac{(\sqrt{5}+\sqrt{3})^2}{5-3} = \frac{5+3+2\sqrt{15}}{2}$$

$$= \frac{8+2\sqrt{15}}{2} = 4+\sqrt{15}$$

$$\therefore y = \frac{\sqrt{5}-\sqrt{3}}{\sqrt{5}+\sqrt{3}} = 4-\sqrt{15}$$

$$\therefore x+y = 4+\sqrt{15}+4-\sqrt{15} = 8$$

4. (b); $\sqrt{2} = 1.414$ (Given)

Now, $\frac{\sqrt{2}-1}{\sqrt{2}+1} = \frac{(\sqrt{2}-1)(\sqrt{2}-1)}{(\sqrt{2}+1)(\sqrt{2}-1)}$

$$= \frac{(\sqrt{2}-1)^2}{2-1} = (\sqrt{2}-1)^2$$

$$\therefore \sqrt{\frac{\sqrt{2}-1}{\sqrt{2}+1}} = \sqrt{(\sqrt{2}-1)^2} = \sqrt{2}-1$$

$$= 1.414 - 1 = 0.414$$

5. (b); $x + \frac{1}{4}\sqrt{x} + a^2 = (\sqrt{x})^2 + 2\sqrt{x} \cdot \frac{1}{8} + (a)^2$

Clearly $a = \frac{1}{8}$.

Then, expression = $\left(\sqrt{x} + \frac{1}{8}\right)^2$

6. (c); $(0.5)^2 = 0.25$, $\sqrt{0.49} = 0.7$

$$\sqrt[3]{0.008} = 0.2, 0.23$$

$$\therefore \sqrt{0.49} > (0.5)^2 > 0.23 > \sqrt[3]{0.008}$$

7. (a); $\sqrt[3]{4}, \sqrt{2}, \sqrt[6]{3}, \sqrt[4]{5}$

$$\text{LCM of } 3, 2, 6, 4 = 12$$

$$\sqrt[3]{4} = (4)^{\frac{1}{3}} = (4)^{\frac{4}{12}} = (4^4)^{\frac{1}{12}} = (256)^{\frac{1}{12}}$$

$$\sqrt{2} = (2)^{\frac{1}{2}} = (2)^{\frac{6}{12}} = (2^6)^{\frac{1}{12}} = (64)^{\frac{1}{12}}$$

$$\sqrt[6]{3} = (3)^{\frac{1}{6}} = (3)^{\frac{2}{12}} = (3^2)^{\frac{1}{12}} = (9)^{\frac{1}{12}}$$

$$\sqrt[4]{5} = (5)^{\frac{1}{4}} = (5)^{\frac{3}{12}} = (5^3)^{\frac{1}{12}} = (125)^{\frac{1}{12}}$$

$$\therefore (256)^{\frac{1}{12}} > (125)^{\frac{1}{12}} > (64)^{\frac{1}{12}} > (9)^{\frac{1}{12}}$$

$$\text{or, } \sqrt[3]{4} > \sqrt[4]{5} > \sqrt{2} > \sqrt[6]{3}$$

8. (b); Expression = $\frac{\sqrt{3} + \sqrt{2}}{\sqrt{3} - \sqrt{2}} - \frac{\sqrt{3} - \sqrt{2}}{\sqrt{3} + \sqrt{2}}$

$$= \frac{(\sqrt{3} + \sqrt{2})^2 - (\sqrt{3} - \sqrt{2})^2}{(\sqrt{3} + \sqrt{2})(\sqrt{3} - \sqrt{2})}$$

$$= \frac{3 + 2 + 2\sqrt{6} - 3 - 2 + 2\sqrt{6}}{(\sqrt{3})^2 - (\sqrt{2})^2} = \frac{4\sqrt{6}}{3 - 2} = 4\sqrt{6}$$

9. (c); $\sqrt{12} + \sqrt{18} = \sqrt{3 \times 2 \times 2} + \sqrt{2 \times 3 \times 3}$

$$= 2\sqrt{3} + 3\sqrt{2}$$

$$\therefore \text{Required difference}$$

$$= 2\sqrt{3} + 3\sqrt{2} - 2\sqrt{3} - 2\sqrt{2} = \sqrt{2}$$

10. (c); LCM of the orders of the surds = LCM of 2, 3, 5 and 7 = 210

$$5^{\frac{1}{2}} = 5^{\frac{105}{210}} = (5^{105})^{\frac{1}{210}}, \quad 4^{\frac{1}{3}} = 4^{\frac{70}{210}} = (4^{70})^{\frac{1}{210}}$$

$$2^{\frac{1}{5}} = 2^{\frac{42}{210}} = (2^{42})^{\frac{1}{210}}, \quad 3^{\frac{1}{7}} = 3^{\frac{30}{210}} = (3^{30})^{\frac{1}{210}}$$

$$\therefore \text{The largest number} = 5^{\frac{1}{2}} = \sqrt{5}$$

Quicker Approach

5 is the largest radicand and its order is smallest.

$$\therefore \text{Largest number} = \sqrt{5}$$

11. (c); Let $x = \sqrt{7\sqrt{7\sqrt{7\sqrt{7}\dots}}}$

On squaring both sides,

$$x^2 = 7x \Rightarrow x^2 - 7x = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow x(x - 7) = 0 \Rightarrow x = 7$$

$$\therefore 7 = (7^3)^{y-1} = 7^{3y-3}$$

$$\Rightarrow 3y - 3 = 1 \Rightarrow 3y = 4$$

$$\Rightarrow y = \frac{4}{3}$$

12. (b); Expression = $\frac{1}{2^{\frac{2}{3}} + 2^{\frac{1}{3}} + 1}$

$$= \frac{2^{\frac{1}{3}} - 1}{\left(2^{\frac{1}{3}} - 1\right)\left(2^{\frac{2}{3}} + 2^{\frac{1}{3}} + 1\right)} = \frac{2^{\frac{1}{3}} - 1}{\left(2^{\frac{1}{3}}\right)^3 - 1}$$

$$= 2^{\frac{1}{3}} - 1 = \sqrt[3]{2} - 1$$

$$[\because (a - b)(a^2 + ab + b^2) = a^3 - b^3]$$

13. (d); $\frac{1}{\sqrt{2} + \sqrt{1}} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2} + \sqrt{1}} \times \frac{\sqrt{2} - 1}{\sqrt{2} - 1}$

$$= \sqrt{2} - 1$$

$$\therefore \text{Expression}$$

$$= \sqrt{2} - 1 + \sqrt{3} - \sqrt{2} + \sqrt{4} - \sqrt{3} + \dots$$

$$+ \sqrt{99} - \sqrt{98} + \sqrt{100} - \sqrt{99}$$

$$= \sqrt{100} - 1 = 10 - 1 = 9$$

14. (a); $\sqrt{6} \times \sqrt{15} = x\sqrt{10}$

$$\Rightarrow \sqrt{2 \times 3} \times \sqrt{3 \times 5} = x\sqrt{10}$$

$$\Rightarrow \sqrt{2} \times \sqrt{5} \times 3 = x\sqrt{10}$$

$$\Rightarrow 3\sqrt{10} = x\sqrt{10} \Rightarrow x = 3$$

15. (b); $\sqrt{7} - \sqrt{5} = \frac{(\sqrt{7} - \sqrt{5})(\sqrt{7} + \sqrt{5})}{\sqrt{7} + \sqrt{5}} = \frac{2}{\sqrt{7} + \sqrt{5}}$

Similarly,

$$\sqrt{5} - \sqrt{3} = \frac{2}{\sqrt{5} + \sqrt{3}}, \quad \sqrt{9} - \sqrt{7} = \frac{2}{\sqrt{9} + \sqrt{7}}$$

$$\sqrt{11} - \sqrt{9} = \frac{2}{\sqrt{11} + \sqrt{9}}$$

$\therefore$ Largest number = $\sqrt{5} - \sqrt{3}$ because its denominator is the smallest.

16. (c); $(0.1)^2 = 0.01$

$$\sqrt{0.0121} = \sqrt{0.11 \times 0.11} = 0.11$$

$$\sqrt{0.0004} = 0.02, \text{ So largest number} = 0.12$$

17. (d); Let $x = \sqrt{6 + \sqrt{6 + \sqrt{6 + \dots}}}$

On squaring both sides,

$$x^2 = 6 + \sqrt{6 + \sqrt{6 + \sqrt{6 + \dots}}}$$

$$\Rightarrow x^2 = 6 + x$$

$$\Rightarrow x^2 - x - 6 = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow x^2 - 3x + 2x - 6 = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow x(x - 3) + 2(x - 3) = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow (x + 2)(x - 3) = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow x = 3 \text{ and } x \neq -2 \text{ because numbers are positive.}$$

18. (c); Expression = $\frac{(81)^{3.6} \times (9)^{2.7}}{(81)^{4.2} \times 3}$

$$= \frac{(3^4)^{3.6} \times (3^2)^{2.7}}{(3^4)^{4.2} \times 3} = \frac{3^{14.4} \times 3^{5.4}}{3^{16.8} \times 3}$$

$$[\because (a^m)^n = a^{mn}; a^m \times a^n = a^{m+n}; a^m \div a^n = a^{m-n}]$$

$$= \frac{3^{14.4+5.4}}{3^{16.8+1}} = \frac{3^{19.8}}{3^{17.8}} = 3^{19.8-17.8} = 3^2 = 9$$

19. (b); $a = \frac{\sqrt{3}-\sqrt{2}}{\sqrt{3}+\sqrt{2}} = \frac{\sqrt{3}-\sqrt{2}}{\sqrt{3}+\sqrt{2}} \times \frac{\sqrt{3}-\sqrt{2}}{\sqrt{3}-\sqrt{2}}$

$$= \frac{(\sqrt{3}-\sqrt{2})^2}{3-2} = 3+2-2\sqrt{6} = 5-2\sqrt{6}$$

$$\therefore b = \frac{\sqrt{3}+\sqrt{2}}{\sqrt{3}-\sqrt{2}} = 5+2\sqrt{6}$$

$$\Rightarrow a + b = 10;$$

$$ab = (5-2\sqrt{6})(5+2\sqrt{6}) = 25-24 = 1$$

$$\therefore \frac{a^2}{b} + \frac{b^2}{a} = \frac{a^3 + b^3}{ab} = \frac{(a+b)^3 - 3ab(a+b)}{ab}$$

$$= 10^3 - 3 \times 10 = 1000 - 30 = 970$$

20. (d); $2\sqrt{x} = \frac{\sqrt{5}+\sqrt{3}}{\sqrt{5}-\sqrt{3}} - \frac{\sqrt{5}-\sqrt{3}}{\sqrt{5}+\sqrt{3}}$

$$= \frac{(\sqrt{5}+\sqrt{3})^2 - (\sqrt{5}-\sqrt{3})^2}{(\sqrt{5}-\sqrt{3})(\sqrt{5}+\sqrt{3})} = \frac{4\sqrt{5}\cdot\sqrt{3}}{5-3} = 2\sqrt{15}$$

$$\therefore 2\sqrt{x} = 2\sqrt{15} \Rightarrow x = 15$$

21. (d); Expression

$$= \frac{3+\sqrt{6}}{5\sqrt{3}-2\sqrt{12}-\sqrt{32}+\sqrt{50}}$$

$$= \frac{3+\sqrt{6}}{5\sqrt{3}-4\sqrt{3}-4\sqrt{2}+5\sqrt{2}}$$

$$= \frac{3+\sqrt{6}}{\sqrt{3}+\sqrt{2}} = \frac{\sqrt{3}(\sqrt{3}+\sqrt{2})}{\sqrt{3}+\sqrt{2}} = \sqrt{3} = 1.732$$

22. (d); Expression = $\sqrt{10+2\sqrt{6}+2\sqrt{10}+2\sqrt{15}}$

$$= \sqrt{10+2\times\sqrt{2}\times\sqrt{3}+2\times\sqrt{2}\times\sqrt{5}+2\times\sqrt{3}\times\sqrt{5}}$$

$$= \sqrt{2+3+5+2\times\sqrt{2}\times\sqrt{3}+2\times\sqrt{2}\times\sqrt{5}+2\times\sqrt{3}\times\sqrt{5}}$$

$$= \sqrt{(\sqrt{2})^2 + (\sqrt{3})^2 + (\sqrt{5})^2 + 2\times\sqrt{2}\times\sqrt{3} + 2\times\sqrt{2}\times\sqrt{5} + 2\times\sqrt{3}\times\sqrt{5}}$$

$$= \sqrt{(\sqrt{2}+\sqrt{3}+\sqrt{5})^2} = \sqrt{2}+\sqrt{3}+\sqrt{5}$$

$$[(a+b+c)^2 = a^2 + b^2 + c^2 + 2ab + 2ac + 2bc]$$

23. (c); $\sqrt{\frac{\sqrt{36}-\sqrt{24}+\sqrt{24}-\sqrt{16}}{5+\sqrt{24}}}$

$$= \sqrt{\frac{6-4}{5+\sqrt{24}}} = \sqrt{\frac{2}{5+\sqrt{24}}} = \sqrt{\frac{2}{5+\sqrt{6}\times 4}}$$

$$= \sqrt{\frac{2}{5+2\sqrt{6}}} = \sqrt{\frac{2}{5+2\sqrt{6}} \times \frac{5-2\sqrt{6}}{5-2\sqrt{6}}}$$

$$= \sqrt{\frac{2(5-2\sqrt{6})}{25-24}} = \sqrt{2(5-2\sqrt{6})}$$

$$= \sqrt{2[(\sqrt{3})^2 + (\sqrt{2})^2 - 2\sqrt{3}\sqrt{2}]}$$

$$= \sqrt{2(\sqrt{3}-\sqrt{2})^2} = \sqrt{2}(\sqrt{3}-\sqrt{2}) = \sqrt{6}-2$$

24. (b); $a = \frac{2+\sqrt{3}}{2-\sqrt{3}} = \frac{(2+\sqrt{3})(2+\sqrt{3})}{(2-\sqrt{3})(2+\sqrt{3})}$

$$= \frac{4+4\sqrt{3}+3}{4-3} = 7+4\sqrt{3}$$

$$\therefore b = \frac{2-\sqrt{3}}{2+\sqrt{3}} = 7-4\sqrt{3}$$

$$\therefore a+b = 7+4\sqrt{3}+7-4\sqrt{3} = 14$$

$$ab = (7+4\sqrt{3})(7-4\sqrt{3})$$

$$= 49 - 48 = 1$$

$$\therefore a^2 + b^2 + ab = (a + b)^2 - ab$$

$$= (14)^2 - 1 = 196 - 1 = 195$$

$$25. \text{ (a); Expression} = \frac{\sqrt{7}}{\sqrt{16+6\sqrt{7}} - \sqrt{16-6\sqrt{7}}}$$

$$= \frac{\sqrt{7}}{\sqrt{9+7+2 \times 3 \times \sqrt{7}} - \sqrt{9+7-2 \times 3 \times \sqrt{7}}}$$

$$= \frac{\sqrt{7}}{(3+\sqrt{7}) - (3-\sqrt{7})} = \frac{\sqrt{7}}{3+\sqrt{7}-3+\sqrt{7}} = \frac{1}{2}$$

26. (c); Required value will be the difference between

$$(\sqrt{12} + \sqrt{18}) \text{ and } (\sqrt{3} + \sqrt{2})$$

$$= (\sqrt{12} + \sqrt{18}) - (\sqrt{3} + \sqrt{2})$$

$$= (2\sqrt{3} + 3\sqrt{2}) - (\sqrt{3} + \sqrt{2})$$

$$= \sqrt{3} + 2\sqrt{2}$$

27. (d); Given, $(256)^{-(4^{-3/2})} = (256)^{-\left(\frac{1}{4^{3/2}}\right)}$

$$= (256)^{-\left(\frac{1}{(2^2)^{3/2}}\right)}$$

$$p^{-n} = \frac{1}{p^n} = (256)^{-\frac{1}{8}} = \frac{1}{(256)^{\frac{1}{8}}} = \frac{1}{(2^8)^{\frac{1}{8}}} = \frac{1}{2}$$

28. (d); $(0.9)^2 = 0.81$

$$\sqrt{0.9} = 0.948, \quad 0.\overline{9} = \frac{9}{9} = 1$$

$\therefore 0.\overline{9}$ is greatest.

29. (b); Expression = $\sqrt[3]{0.004096}$

In this type of question the decimal digit is converted into decimal fraction.

$$= \sqrt[3]{\frac{4096}{1000000}}$$

We know that, $\sqrt[3]{4096} = 16$

and $\sqrt[3]{1000000} = 100$

$$\therefore \sqrt[3]{\frac{16}{100}}$$

We know that, $\sqrt{16} = 4$ and $\sqrt{100} = 10$

$$\therefore \sqrt{\frac{16}{100}} = \frac{4}{10} = 0.4$$

30. (b); $(2.89)^{0.5} = (2.89)^{\frac{1}{2}} = (1.7^2)^{1/2} = 1.7$

$$\Rightarrow 2 - (0.5)^2 = 2 - 0.25 = 1.75,$$

$$\Rightarrow \sqrt{3} = 1.732$$

$$\text{and } \sqrt[3]{0.008} = \sqrt[3]{0.2 \times 0.2 \times 0.2} = 0.2$$

Arrange in ascending order

$$\sqrt[3]{0.008} < (2.89)^{0.5} < \sqrt{3} < 2 - (0.5)^2$$